ENGLISH FOR WORK / SERVICE DESK / INFRASTRUCTURE / OPERATIONS

General IT English

Clear language for reliable services and accountable decisions.



Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.
No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.

Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

Your route through the book

01 IT Service Language, Tickets, and Triage, page 4

Narrow an ambiguous incident report and agree on an evidence-based update.

02 Networks, Connectivity, and Root-Cause Hypotheses, page 14

Challenge premature certainty and agree on comparisons that separate hypotheses.

03 Identity, Access, and Permissions, page 27

Clarify the required task and refuse excessive access while offering a legitimate route.

04 Cloud, Infrastructure, and Cost-Aware Operations, page 37

Compare incomplete estimates and qualify a recommendation without inventing missing costs.

05 Endpoints, Servers, Patching, and Configuration Management, page 49

Report deployment states accurately and define evidence needed for completion.

06 Security Operations, Risk, and Incident Response, page 59

Escalate a security observation with urgency, accurate scope, and controlled evidence.

07 Change, Release, Problem, and Post-Incident Communication, page 73

Replace an inaccurate notice, acknowledge impact, and confirm the controlling record.

08 Platform, DevOps, Observability, and Kubernetes Conversations, page 84

Challenge a narrow health claim and coordinate investigation around user-visible evidence.

Professional communication notes, page 3

Three additional workplace cases, page 99

Answers and explanations, page 110

Phrase finder, page 168

Vocabulary index, page 170

References and publication notes, page 175

Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

Describe the service, not just the server.

IT conversations cross technical and business boundaries. A useful message identifies the affected function, the evidence, the operational impact, and the next owner without turning a hypothesis into a confirmed cause.

Translate impact into a specific function

"The system is down" may mean that one export fails while sign-in and other tasks still work. Clarify the task before choosing the priority.
"You can sign in, but invoice export fails. Which users and periods have you checked?"

Distinguish a clue from a diagnosis

A pattern can narrow an investigation without proving its cause. Ask which test supports the proposed explanation.
"The failure occurs through the VPN; DNS remains one hypothesis, not the established cause."

Make status words operational

Downloaded, installed, restarted, verified, and complete describe different states. A status update should make the remaining work visible.
"Installation succeeded on 180 laptops; twelve are offline and eight returned errors."

Separate urgency from permission

A business deadline can justify prompt escalation but does not itself authorize unrestricted access or an unreviewed production change.
"I will expedite the reporting-role request; administrator access needs separate justification."

Professional boundaries

Fictional workplace language practice, not instructions for administering real systems or handling live incidents. Follow authorized procedures, access controls, and qualified security review. Use invented accounts and records in practice.

A Read the situation

LESSON 01 / IT SERVICE LANGUAGE, TICKETS, AND TRIAGE

Narrow an ambiguous incident report and agree on an evidence-based update.

> **"The system is down" means the export fails**
>
> Ren reports that the finance system is down. Ren can sign in and view invoices, but exporting the current month produces an error. Two colleagues report the same export problem; other users and functions have not been checked. The billing team needs its file by 3 p.m. Asha owns service-desk triage and can escalate the ticket, but cannot promise a repair time.

People: Asha, Service-desk analyst; Ren, Billing coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which function is confirmed to fail?

A. Signing in
B. Viewing every invoice
C. Every function for every user
D. Exporting the current month's invoices

2. How many people have reported the export issue?

A. One
B. Two hundred
C. Every employee
D. Three

3. What may Asha promise?

A. An escalation and a timed update
B. A repair before 3 p.m.
C. That no other function is affected
D. That the billing deadline will be waived

Answers and explanations, page 110

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

service desk
The contact point coordinating user support.
contact the service desk

ticket
A recorded request or issue for tracking.
update the ticket

triage
Initial assessment of impact, priority, and ownership.
triage an incident

incident
An unplanned disruption or reduction in service.
report a service incident

service request
A request for a routine agreed service.
fulfill a service request

impact
The effect on users or business work.
assess business impact

urgency
How quickly action is needed in the circumstances.
establish the urgency

priority
The relative order or importance assigned to work.
assign a ticket priority

affected user
A person experiencing the reported problem.
identify affected users

scope
The functions, users, or locations included.
establish the incident scope

symptom
An observed sign of a problem.
record the exact symptom

error message
Text identifying or describing an error condition.
capture the error message

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

service desk SERVICE DESK

contact the service desk

Keep the meaning precise: The contact point coordinating user support.

impact IMPACT

assess business impact

Keep the meaning precise: The effect on users or business work.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

reproduce
Make the reported behavior occur again.

reproduce the export failure

resolution
Restoration or completion according to the agreed criteria.

confirm the resolution

restoration time
Time until a disrupted service is restored.

estimate restoration time cautiously

assignment group
The team designated to handle a ticket.

confirm the assignment group

knowledge article
A maintained support reference for a known task or issue.

check the knowledge article

status update
A communication of progress and remaining uncertainty.

send a timed status update

workaround
A temporary way to reduce impact without fixing the cause.

verify a workaround

response time
Time until support responds under a defined measure.

distinguish response time from repair time

escalation
Referral for higher authority or specialist attention.

request a technical escalation

service owner
The role accountable for the service.

notify the service owner

duplicate ticket
Another ticket reporting the same underlying incident.

link a duplicate ticket

closure criterion
A condition required before work is marked closed.

agree on closure criteria

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

error message ERROR MESSAGE

capture the error message

Keep the meaning precise: Text identifying or describing an error condition.

restoration time RESTORATION TIME

estimate restoration time cautiously

Keep the meaning precise: Time until a disrupted service is restored.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge impact

I understand the export is blocking your billing file.

Check what works

Can you still view the invoices on screen?

Request evidence

Please send the exact error text through the approved support channel.

Offer a commitment

I will escalate the ticket and update you by noon.

Check a workaround

Has anyone verified that the alternative produces the required file?

Explain escalation

I am asking the application team to investigate this function.

Link related reports

I will link the reports so the investigation has one shared record.

Define closure

We will confirm that the required export works before closing the incident.

Narrow the function

Which action fails after you sign in?

Establish scope

Who else has tried the same export and seen the error?

Separate deadlines

Your billing deadline is 3 p.m.; the repair time is not yet known.

Read back the issue

Sign-in and viewing work; the current-month export fails for three reported users.

Avoid a promise

I cannot confirm a restoration time before the technical assessment.

Preserve uncertainty

Other functions and users have not yet been checked.

Confirm the owner

Which team is accepting the next investigation step?

Close the update

The next message will include findings, outstanding questions, and the next owner.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Establish scope
Useful wording: Who else has tried the same export and seen the error?

Purpose: Request evidence
Useful wording: Please send the exact error text through the approved support channel.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which ticket summary is most accurate?

A. Only Ren is affected and all other functions are verified.

B. The export has already been restored.

C. Current-month export fails for three reported users; sign-in and viewing work for Ren.

D. The entire finance platform is unavailable to every user.

2. Which statement promises communication rather than repair?

A. The export will be fixed by noon.

B. Every user will be unblocked by noon.

C. No technical investigation will be needed.

D. I will send a progress update by noon.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An unplanned disruption or reduction in service. Which term fits?

A. knowledge article

B. resolution

C. affected user

D. incident

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from ""The system is down" means the export fails". Ren: "Two colleagues have the same problem. We have not checked older periods or asked the other office. Does that mean it is a major outage?" Asha: [missing response] Ren: "Please do. Would a screenshot help? It shows invoice details, so I do not want to paste it into the general team chat." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Then it is an unverified workaround, not a solution I can recommend as complete. I will ask the service owner to assess an acceptable alternative.

B. It means three users have reported this symptom. I need the agreed impact assessment before assigning a broader classification, but I can escalate now.

C. I cannot promise a restoration time before their assessment. I can commit to a progress update by noon, even if the cause remains unknown.

D. Use the approved support channel and follow its handling rules. The exact error message and approximate time will help the application team locate the event.

Answers and explanations, page 110

One useful distinction

Urgency concerns time pressure; impact concerns consequences and scope. Priority normally reflects an organization's agreed assessment, not just the strongest wording in a ticket. A response commitment is not a repair guarantee.

E Conversation

"The system is down" means the export fails

"The system is down" means the export fails

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

impact / workaround / closure criterion / restoration time / assignment group / scope / escalation / error message / symptom / duplicate ticket

01 **Ren:** The finance system is down, and billing needs the monthly file by three. I have already tried twice, so this is becoming urgent for us.

02 **Asha:** I understand the business [1] _____. To route this correctly, can you tell me which action fails after you open the application?

03 **Ren:** I can sign in and see the invoices. When I choose the current month and export, I get an error instead of the file.

04 **Asha:** That narrows the [2] _____. I will record an export failure, while keeping the billing deadline visible in the ticket.

05 **Ren:** Two colleagues have the same problem. We have not checked older periods or asked the other office. Does that mean it is a major outage?

06 **Asha:** It means three users have reported this [3] _____. I need the agreed impact assessment before assigning a broader classification, but I can escalate now.

07 **Ren:** Please do. Would a screenshot help? It shows invoice details, so I do not want to paste it into the general team chat.

08 **Asha:** Use the approved support channel and follow its handling rules. The exact [4] _____ and approximate time will help the application team locate the event.

09 **Ren:** Someone suggested copying the visible rows manually. I am worried that might omit invoices across multiple pages, and we have not checked the totals.

10 **Asha:** Then it is an unverified [5] _____, not a solution I can recommend as complete. I will ask the service owner to assess an acceptable alternative.

Conversation continues on the next page.

"The system is down" means the export fails

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Ren:** Can I tell my manager the technical team will fix it before three? They are asking me for a firm answer about the billing run.

12 **Asha:** I cannot promise a [6] _____ before their assessment. I can commit to a progress update by noon, even if the cause remains unknown.

13 **Ren:** Noon for an update, not necessarily a fix. I'll make that clear to my manager. Please put it in the ticket too.

14 **Asha:** I will. I am sending a technical [7] _____ with the confirmed scope, the error details, and your business deadline as separate fields.

15 **Ren:** My colleagues each opened a ticket. Should they close theirs now, or leave them open so the team can see that this is not just me?

16 **Asha:** I will link them to the main record as related reports. A [8] _____ can be managed without suggesting that the underlying export problem is resolved.

17 **Ren:** Could you read that back before you send it? I don't want the team checking invoice viewing when it's the export I need.

18 **Asha:** Certainly. Sign-in and viewing work for you; current-month export fails for three reported users. Other functions remain unchecked. Billing needs the file by three, and the [9] _____ is the application support team.

19 **Ren:** That captures it. Please include me on the noon update. Once they say it is fixed, I can verify the export and compare the file totals.

20 **Asha:** I will record that as the [10] _____. We will distinguish a reported fix from your confirmation that the required task works again.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. impact / **2.** scope / **3.** symptom / **4.** error message / **5.** workaround / **6.** restoration time / **7.** escalation / **8.** duplicate ticket / **9.** assignment group / **10.** closure criterion

Why these answers fit, page 111

F Check accuracy and scope

"The system is down" means the export fails

Return to the case

Ren reports that the finance system is down. Ren can sign in and view invoices, but exporting the current month produces an error. Two colleagues report the same export problem; other users and functions have not been checked. The billing team needs its file by 3 p.m. Asha owns service-desk triage and can escalate the ticket, but cannot promise a repair time.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which question establishes business impact?

A. Which error code did the export return?
B. Does the failure occur for earlier reporting periods too?
C. Which application team owns export processing?
D. What work cannot proceed without that file?

2. What does "three reported users" avoid claiming?

A. That anyone has reported a fault
B. That the issue has an impact
C. That a ticket can be escalated
D. That the affected population is limited to three

Answers and explanations, page 113

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Keep the 3 p.m. billing deadline separate from the unknown repair time; repeat the noon progress-update commitment.

Clarification is part of taking the problem seriously

A user may describe the whole system as down because one blocked function prevents their work. Acknowledge the business impact, then narrow the technical description without arguing about the word down.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Printing fails, but document editing still works

A user can edit and save documents but cannot print to one office printer. Another printer has not been tested. The user needs printed copies for a 2 p.m. meeting.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

restoration / failure / printer / update

01 **Analyst:** The confirmed [1] _____ is printing to that device, not document editing.

02 **User:** I have not verified an alternative [2] _____ yet.

03 **Analyst:** I will report the meeting deadline separately from the unknown [3] _____ time.

04 **User:** Please give me a timed [4] _____ even if the repair is still pending.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. failure / **2.** printer / **3.** restoration / **4.** update

Why these answers fit, page 113

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from ""The system is down" means the export fails". Ren: "Noon for an update, not necessarily a fix. I'll make that clear to my manager. Please put it in the ticket too." Asha: [missing response] Ren: "My colleagues each opened a ticket. Should they close theirs now, or leave them open so the team can see that this is not just me?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I understand the business impact. To route this correctly, can you tell me which action fails after you open the application?

B. I will record that as the closure criterion. We will distinguish a reported fix from your confirmation that the required task works again.

C. I will. I am sending a technical escalation with the confirmed scope, the error details, and your business deadline as separate fields.

D. It means three users have reported this symptom. I need the agreed impact assessment before assigning a broader classification, but I can escalate now.

Answers and explanations, page 114

A Read the situation

LESSON 02 / NETWORKS, CONNECTIVITY, AND ROOT-CAUSE HYPOTHESES

Challenge premature certainty and agree on comparisons that separate hypotheses.

> **The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis**
>
> The staff portal works from the office network but fails for four people connected through the virtual private network (VPN). The same portal address is used. Nobody has checked name resolution, routing, or access-policy logs for those requests. Eli says DNS must be the cause. Nia coordinates network investigation. The team has an approved diagnostic process and must not change production settings merely to test a guess.

People: Eli, Support engineer; Nia, Network engineer.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which pattern is established?

A. Every internet connection fails.
B. DNS returns the wrong address.
C. A firewall rule has been identified.
D. Office access works; four VPN users report failure.

2. Which cause is confirmed?

A. None of the proposed causes
B. DNS
C. Routing
D. An access-policy rule

3. What constraint applies to investigation?

A. Treat confidence as evidence.
B. Tell users that every path is healthy.
C. Follow the approved process without changing production on a guess.
D. Disable production controls immediately.

Answers and explanations, page 115

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

VPN
Virtual private network; a connection providing a defined private access path.

connect through the VPN

DNS
Domain Name System; the system that resolves names to records.

investigate a DNS hypothesis

name resolution
Translating a name into the records needed for a connection.

verify name resolution

IP address
A numerical network address used by the Internet Protocol.

compare resolved IP addresses

hostname
A name identifying a host or service endpoint.

confirm the hostname

resolver
A service that answers or obtains DNS responses.

identify the configured resolver

cache
Stored data reused to avoid repeating work.

inspect a cached response

TTL
Time to live; a lifetime limit, with meaning depending on context.

check a DNS record's TTL

routing
Selection of paths for network traffic.

review routing evidence

route
A path or forwarding rule for reaching a destination.

inspect the relevant route

gateway
A system providing a path between networks or services.

identify the gateway

subnet
A defined subdivision of an IP network.

compare affected subnets

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

VPN VPN

connect through the VPN

Keep the meaning precise: Virtual private network; a connection providing a defined private access path.

resolver RESOLVER

identify the configured resolver

Keep the meaning precise: A service that answers or obtains DNS responses.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

firewall

A control that permits or blocks network traffic under rules.

review firewall logs

access policy

Rules determining permitted access under stated conditions.

check the access policy

port

A numbered transport endpoint associated with a service.

identify the service port

packet loss

Failure of transmitted network packets to reach their destination.

measure packet loss

round-trip time

Time for a request and return response across a path.

compare round-trip times

timeout

Expiry of a waiting period before a response completes.

record a connection timeout

connection refusal

An explicit rejection of a connection attempt.

distinguish refusal from timeout

TLS

Transport Layer Security; protection for communication in transit.

inspect a TLS handshake error

certificate

A signed digital statement used to bind identity and a public key.

review a certificate warning

proxy

An intermediary handling requests between client and destination.

identify the proxy path

reachability

Whether a destination can be contacted under specified conditions.

test service reachability

diagnostic hypothesis

A proposed explanation that still requires testing.

test a diagnostic hypothesis

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

subnet SUBNET

compare affected subnets

Keep the meaning precise: A defined subdivision of an IP network.

round-trip time ROUND-TRIP TIME

compare round-trip times

Keep the meaning precise: Time for a request and return response across a path.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge a pattern

The reports do point to a difference between access paths.

State a hypothesis

Name resolution is one explanation we still need to test.

Define a comparison

Compare the same destination from the two approved paths.

Name missing evidence

We have not checked the resolver or policy logs for those requests.

Check the source

Were all four reports from the same VPN profile?

Limit an observation

The portal worked for this office test at this time.

Ask for timestamps

Please include the time and time zone for each failed request.

Report a negative result

That check did not support the DNS hypothesis.

Challenge certainty

What evidence establishes DNS rather than another path issue?

Request exact wording

Was it a timeout, a refusal, or a certificate warning?

Preserve controls

We should not change production settings to test an unverified guess.

Close the inference

The pattern narrows the investigation; it does not yet establish a cause.

Distinguish layers

A successful name lookup does not prove application access.

Avoid a universal claim

We have not tested every VPN user or destination.

Assign a test

Who will collect the approved comparison and record the results?

Preserve the record

Keep the observed results separate from the proposed explanation.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Request exact wording
Useful wording: Was it a timeout, a refusal, or a certificate warning?

Purpose: Define a comparison
Useful wording: Compare the same destination from the two approved paths.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which statement preserves the evidence boundary?

A. Every network component is broken.

B. A connected VPN guarantees portal access.

C. The VPN path is associated with the reported failures; the cause is unconfirmed.

D. DNS has been proven faulty because office access works.

2. Which question distinguishes the observed failure from a proposed cause?

A. Is DNS the cause because the office path works?

B. Did the VPN profile cause a firewall failure?

C. Should we assume the resolver differs before checking it?

D. Did the request time out, get refused, or show a certificate warning?

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A numerical network address used by the Internet Protocol. Which term fits?

A. certificate

B. port

C. routing

D. IP address

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis". Eli: "I can collect the wording and timestamps. Does the fact that their VPN says connected tell us that the connection to the portal is available?" Nia: [missing response] Eli: "Someone suggested changing the resolver for all VPN users and seeing whether the complaints stop. That would be a quick way to test the theory." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No. It confirms that connection state, not portal reachability. We need to follow the approved diagnostic process for the destination they actually need.

B. No. Record what that check establishes, then review the next evidence. A matching answer does not automatically prove an access policy caused the failure.

C. Then ask for the exact symptom. A timeout, a refusal, and a certificate warning should not be recorded as the same observation.

D. The access-path pattern is useful, but DNS is still a hypothesis. What result distinguishes name resolution from routing or an access-policy issue?

Answers and explanations, page 115

> **One useful distinction**
>
> A timeout, a refused connection, and a certificate warning are different observations. "The VPN is connected" does not establish that every destination is reachable. Name the source, destination, and observed result.

E Conversation

The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis

The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

timeout / hypothesis / reachability / access policy / hostname / name resolution / time zone / comparison / symptom / diagnosis

01 **Eli:** Four VPN users cannot reach the staff portal, while the office test works. This must be DNS. I am ready to put that in the incident update.

02 **Nia:** The access-path pattern is useful, but DNS is still a [1] _____. What result distinguishes name resolution from routing or an access-policy issue?

03 **Eli:** We do not have that result yet. The reports all use the same portal address, and everyone says the page will not open after connecting.

04 **Nia:** Then ask for the exact [2] _____. A timeout, a refusal, and a certificate warning should not be recorded as the same observation.

05 **Eli:** I can collect the wording and timestamps. Does the fact that their VPN says connected tell us that the connection to the portal is available?

06 **Nia:** No. It confirms that connection state, not portal [3] _____. We need to follow the approved diagnostic process for the destination they actually need.

07 **Eli:** Someone suggested changing the resolver for all VPN users and seeing whether the complaints stop. That would be a quick way to test the theory.

08 **Nia:** A production change has its own approval requirements. First collect the authorized comparison of [4] _____ and the relevant path evidence without altering everyone else's settings.

09 **Eli:** Understood. I will ask whether all four people use the same VPN profile. If they do, that may help us narrow where to compare the configuration.

10 **Nia:** Yes, and include the source network and [5] _____. We want comparable requests, not a working office test against a different address.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Eli:** If the lookup gives the same address on both paths, should we remove DNS from the report completely and say it is definitely the firewall?

12 **Nia:** No. Record what that check establishes, then review the next evidence. A matching answer does not automatically prove an [6] _____ caused the failure.

13 **Eli:** I'll ask whether the page eventually opens or never loads. The reports just say slow, so I may have combined different problems.

14 **Nia:** Exactly. Record a [7] _____ only if that is the actual result. Do not infer it from a user saying the request took too long.

15 **Eli:** Who should collect the approved network checks? I can gather user reports, but I do not have permission to inspect every network device involved.

16 **Nia:** I will coordinate the network evidence and name the appropriate owner for each boundary. Include the [8] _____ so we can match the requests to the correct records.

17 **Eli:** I will revise the update: four reports through the VPN, one successful office test, exact errors being collected, and no verified root cause yet.

18 **Nia:** Good. The [9] _____ should show what differs and what remains unchanged. That gives the next team something concrete to investigate.

19 **Eli:** I'll remove the definite DNS diagnosis from the update now. Send me the comparison when it's ready and I'll add what it shows.

20 **Nia:** Exactly. A useful [10] _____ depends on the evidence, not on keeping the first guess. We can be decisive about the next test while remaining uncertain about the cause.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. hypothesis / **2.** symptom / **3.** reachability / **4.** name resolution / **5.** hostname / **6.** access policy / **7.** timeout / **8.** time zone / **9.** comparison / **10.** diagnosis

Why these answers fit, page 116

F Check accuracy and scope

The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis

Return to the case

The staff portal works from the office network but fails for four people connected through the virtual private network (VPN). The same portal address is used. Nobody has checked name resolution, routing, or access-policy logs for those requests. Eli says DNS must be the cause. Nia coordinates network investigation. The team has an approved diagnostic process and must not change production settings merely to test a guess.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What does a successful name lookup establish?

A. That no packet can be lost
B. That this lookup returned a result under the tested conditions
C. That the application must be reachable
D. That the user's permissions are correct

2. Which commitment is appropriate before diagnosis?

A. I will report the comparison results and remaining hypotheses.
B. I will fix DNS before confirming it is involved.
C. I will remove every access control today.
D. I will certify all VPN traffic as healthy.

Answers and explanations, page 118

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Request the exact warning, path and timestamp through the approved process, without proposing a speculative production change.

Question the inference, not the colleague

A confident diagnosis can spread faster than its evidence. Acknowledge the useful pattern and ask what would distinguish competing explanations. "What supports DNS over routing?" preserves the investigation without making disagreement personal.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

One browser reports a certificate warning

The same portal opens in an approved office test, while a remote user reports a certificate warning. No certificate or proxy review has occurred. The team must describe the actual warning without telling the user to bypass it.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

warning / hypothesis / bypass / timestamp

01 **Analyst:** The reported symptom is a certificate [1] _____, not a confirmed DNS failure.

02 **Engineer:** Record the hostname and the [2] _____ with its time zone.

03 **Analyst:** The proxy path is another [3] _____ to investigate.

04 **Engineer:** Follow the approved process; do not ask the user to [4] _____ the warning.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. warning / **2.** timestamp / **3.** hypothesis / **4.** bypass

Why these answers fit, page 118

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis". Eli: "I'll ask whether the page eventually opens or never loads. The reports just say slow, so I may have combined different problems." Nia: [missing response] Eli: "Who should collect the approved network checks? I can gather user reports, but I do not have permission to inspect every network device involved." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Record a timeout only if that is the actual result. Do not infer it from a user saying the request took too long.

B. No. Record what that check establishes, then review the next evidence. A matching answer does not automatically prove an access policy caused the failure.

C. The access-path pattern is useful, but DNS is still a hypothesis. What result distinguishes name resolution from routing or an access-policy issue?

D. No. It confirms that connection state, not portal reachability. We need to follow the approved diagnostic process for the destination they actually need.

Answers and explanations, page 119

Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "IT Service Language, Tickets, and Triage" and "Networks, Connectivity, and Root-Cause Hypotheses". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Initial assessment of impact, priority, and ownership. Which term fits?

A. priority
B. service owner
C. workaround
D. triage

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Time to live; a lifetime limit, with meaning depending on context. Which term fits?

A. firewall
B. VPN
C. TTL
D. connection refusal

3. Rebuild the exchange from ""The system is down" means the export fails". Ren: "Someone suggested copying the visible rows manually. I am worried that might omit invoices across multiple pages, and we have not checked the totals." Asha: [missing response] Ren: "Can I tell my manager the technical team will fix it before three? They are asking me for a firm answer about the billing run." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I cannot promise a restoration time before their assessment. I can commit to a progress update by noon, even if the cause remains unknown.
B. It means three users have reported this symptom. I need the agreed impact assessment before assigning a broader classification, but I can escalate now.
C. Then it is an unverified workaround, not a solution I can recommend as complete. I will ask the service owner to assess an acceptable alternative.
D. Use the approved support channel and follow its handling rules. The exact error message and approximate time will help the application team locate the event.

Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis". Eli: "I will revise the update: four reports through the VPN, one successful office test, exact errors being collected, and no verified root cause yet." Nia: [missing response] Eli: "I'll remove the definite DNS diagnosis from the update now. Send me the comparison when it's ready and I'll add what it shows." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes, and include the source network and hostname. We want comparable requests, not a working office test against a different address.

B. The access-path pattern is useful, but DNS is still a hypothesis. What result distinguishes name resolution from routing or an access-policy issue?

C. Then ask for the exact symptom. A timeout, a refusal, and a certificate warning should not be recorded as the same observation.

D. Good. The comparison should show what differs and what remains unchanged. That gives the next team something concrete to investigate.

Answers and explanations, page 150

A Read the situation

LESSON 03 / IDENTITY, ACCESS, AND PERMISSIONS

Clarify the required task and refuse excessive access while offering a legitimate route.

> **A report request does not justify administrator access**
>
> A temporary analyst, Jo, needs to download a monthly report. Jo requests administrator access because the current account shows an access-denied message. A reporting role may allow the required download, but its exact permissions have not been verified. Imani handles access requests. The manager can confirm Jo's business need; the system owner approves the role. The assignment ends on 30 November.

People: Jo, Temporary analyst; Imani, Identity and access analyst.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What task does Jo need to perform?

A. Reconfigure the system
B. Approve other users' roles
C. Download a monthly report
D. Change all user accounts

2. Who approves the system role?

A. The system owner
B. Jo alone
C. Any colleague with access
D. The manager without system review

3. What remains unverified?

A. Whether Jo is temporary
B. The assignment end date
C. Whether an access request exists
D. Whether the reporting role permits the download

Answers and explanations, page 120

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

identity
The representation of a user or service in a system.

verify the account identity

authentication
Establishing that a claimant controls the required identity evidence.

complete authentication

authorization
Permission to perform an action on a resource.

check authorization

permission
An allowed action or access right.

grant a specific permission

role
A defined collection of access rights or responsibilities.

assign a reporting role

RBAC
Role-based access control; access organized through defined roles.

review an RBAC assignment

least privilege
Access limited to what is needed for the task.

apply least privilege

administrator
A role with broad system-management permissions.

justify administrator access

privileged access
Access allowing sensitive or powerful actions.

review privileged access

entitlement
A specific granted right to use a resource or capability.

review account entitlements

provisioning
Creating or assigning accounts and access.

complete approved provisioning

deprovisioning
Removing accounts or access no longer required.

schedule deprovisioning

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

identity IDENTITY

verify the account identity

Keep the meaning precise: The representation of a user or service in a system.

RBAC RBAC

review an RBAC assignment

Keep the meaning precise: Role-based access control; access organized through defined roles.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

access review

A check that granted access remains appropriate.

conduct an access review

access request

A recorded request for specified permissions.

submit a scoped access request

business justification

The work-related reason supporting a request.

document the business justification

approver

The person authorized to approve a request.

identify the correct approver

expiration

The point at which an entitlement or credential ends.

set an access expiration

temporary access

Access granted for a defined limited period.

request temporary access

separation of duties

Dividing incompatible responsibilities to reduce risk.

preserve separation of duties

SSO

Single sign-on; using one authentication session across services.

troubleshoot an SSO session

MFA

Multifactor authentication; use of distinct factor types.

complete MFA verification

service account

An identity used by an application or automated process.

identify the service-account owner

audit log

A record of relevant actions for review.

inspect the access audit log

access denied

A message indicating that an attempted action was not permitted.

report an access-denied message

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

deprovisioning DEPROVISIONING

schedule deprovisioning

Keep the meaning precise: Removing accounts or access no longer required.

expiration EXPIRATION

set an access expiration

Keep the meaning precise: The point at which an entitlement or credential ends.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Clarify the action

Which report do you need, and what action must you perform?

Refuse proportionately

I cannot justify administrator rights from the stated reporting task.

Name the approver

Your manager confirms the need; the system owner approves the role.

Preserve uncertainty

The role may fit, but its permissions still need checking.

Avoid credential sharing

Please use your own approved account rather than another person's credentials.

Explain least privilege

The request should provide the required action without unrelated control.

Check completion

After provisioning, confirm the authorized report action works.

Distinguish roles

A reporting role and an administrator role serve different purposes.

Separate identity and access

You can sign in; the download permission is a different question.

Offer a narrower route

Let us verify whether the reporting role covers that download.

Limit duration

The requested access should match the assignment ending on 30 November.

Confirm the request

I will submit the task, resource, duration, and approval route together.

Check existing rights

Which entitlement is currently assigned to your account?

Handle urgency

I can flag the deadline without bypassing the approval process.

Record an end

Who will verify removal when the assignment finishes?

Close clearly

Approval is pending; the request has been submitted, not granted.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Offer a narrower route
Useful wording: Let us verify whether the reporting role covers that download.

Purpose: Name the approver
Useful wording: Your manager confirms the need; the system owner approves the role.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which request is best scoped?

A. Permanent administrator access to all systems

B. Permission to use a colleague's account

C. Access to every financial record because one export fails

D. Access to download the named monthly report for the assignment period

2. Which statement distinguishes authentication from authorization?

A. MFA approval replaces system-owner approval.

B. Signing in does not prove permission to download the report.

C. Signing in grants every application permission.

D. A role name proves every entitlement.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An allowed action or access right. Which term fits?

A. business justification

B. permission

C. MFA

D. privileged access

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A report request does not justify administrator access". Jo: "I assumed signing in meant I already had access and the download error was just a technical fault. Are those separate parts of the process?" Imani: [missing response] Jo: "Could you assign the reporting role now and let me check whether it works? My manager needs the analysis, and I am only here temporarily." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Approval and provisioning are separate states. After the role is assigned, confirm that the authorized download works with your own account.

B. Yes. Authentication gets you through the identity check. Authorization determines which resources and actions the account is allowed to use afterward.

C. Let us identify the required permission first. Which report are you downloading, and do you need to change anything in the system?

D. Then administrator rights would be broader than that business justification. There may be a reporting role that provides the specific action.

Answers and explanations, page 120

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Authentication establishes identity evidence; authorization governs permitted actions. Being able to sign in does not imply permission to download every report. A role name alone does not prove its actual rights.

E Conversation

A report request does not justify administrator access

A report request does not justify administrator access

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

permission / expiration / deprovisioning / entitlements / business justification / provisioning / least privilege / approver / credentials / Authentication

01 **Jo:** I need administrator access to finish the monthly reporting work. I can sign in, but the download gives me an access-denied message every time.

02 **Imani:** Let us identify the required [1] _____ first. Which report are you downloading, and do you need to change anything in the system?

03 **Jo:** It is the monthly sales summary. I only need to download it and analyze the file. I am not changing accounts or system settings.

04 **Imani:** Then administrator rights would be broader than that [2] _____. There may be a reporting role that provides the specific action.

05 **Jo:** I assumed signing in meant I already had access and the download error was just a technical fault. Are those separate parts of the process?

06 **Imani:** Yes. [3] _____ gets you through the identity check. Authorization determines which resources and actions the account is allowed to use afterward.

07 **Jo:** Could you assign the reporting role now and let me check whether it works? My manager needs the analysis, and I am only here temporarily.

08 **Imani:** The system owner must approve it first. I also need to verify its actual [4] _____, because the role name alone does not confirm that download is included.

09 **Jo:** My manager can confirm the work is required. Does that approval cover the role too, or does the system owner need a separate request?

10 **Imani:** In this process they have different responsibilities. The manager confirms the need, and the system owner is the [5] _____ for the system role.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A report request does not justify administrator access

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Jo:** That is clear. The assignment ends on 30 November. I do not expect to need the system afterward unless the contract is formally extended.

12 **Imani:** I will include an [6] _____ aligned with that assignment and the required review route if it changes.

13 **Jo:** While we wait, a colleague offered to download the file using their account. Is that the same as sharing their password so I can do it myself?

14 **Imani:** Those are different proposals, and neither should bypass the approved process. Do not share [7] _____. Ask the report owner whether an authorized delivery route is permitted.

15 **Jo:** I'll ask the report owner. In the meantime, can you flag the deadline and get the role review moving?

16 **Imani:** Exactly. We can expedite review while preserving [8] _____. I will submit the report name, required action, duration, and business justification together.

17 **Jo:** Will the approval email mean I can download immediately, or is there another step after that?

18 **Imani:** Approval and [9] _____ are separate states. After the role is assigned, confirm that the authorized download works with your own account.

19 **Jo:** And at the end of November, the access should be removed unless an extension is reviewed. Please include who checks that so it is not forgotten.

20 **Imani:** I will record [10] _____ ownership. For now the status is submitted for review, not granted, and we have a legitimate route that matches the work you actually need to do.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. permission / **2.** business justification / **3.** Authentication / **4.** entitlements / **5.** approver / **6.** expiration / **7.** credentials / **8.** least privilege / **9.** provisioning / **10.** deprovisioning

Why these answers fit, page 121

F Check accuracy and scope

A report request does not justify administrator access

Return to the case

A temporary analyst, Jo, needs to download a monthly report. Jo requests administrator access because the current account shows an access-denied message. A reporting role may allow the required download, but its exact permissions have not been verified. Imani handles access requests. The manager can confirm Jo's business need; the system owner approves the role. The assignment ends on 30 November.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Who should confirm business need in this case?

A. The system owner instead of the stated manager
B. Imani by treating ticket submission as business approval
C. A colleague who already has the reporting role
D. Jo's manager

2. Which status is accurate before approval?

A. Permanent because no removal date was discussed.
B. Submitted for review; access has not been granted.
C. Approved because the request is urgent.
D. Provisioned because the manager received the message.

Answers and explanations, page 123

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Distinguish the manager's confirmation of need from the system owner's approval; do not substitute administrator rights for the scoped request.

Offer a route, not just a refusal

A user may ask for administrator rights as a shortcut because they do not know which role fits the task. Clarify the action, explain the authority boundary, and name the narrower request and approval needed. Urgency does not establish permission.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

A contractor needs read-only dashboard access

A contractor needs to view one project dashboard for two weeks, not edit it. The project manager confirms the need; the dashboard owner approves access. No approval has yet been recorded.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

pending / duration / viewing / approval

01 **Analyst:** The requested action is [1] _____, not editing or administration.

02 **Manager:** I can confirm the business need, but the owner provides [2] _____.

03 **Analyst:** The request will include a two-week [3] _____.

04 **Manager:** Until review is complete, describe the access as [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. viewing / **2.** approval / **3.** duration / **4.** pending

Why these answers fit, page 123

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A report request does not justify administrator access". Jo: "While we wait, a colleague offered to download the file using their account. Is that the same as sharing their password so I can do it myself?" Imani: [missing response] Jo: "I'll ask the report owner. In the meantime, can you flag the deadline and get the role review moving?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Those are different proposals, and neither should bypass the approved process. Do not share credentials. Ask the report owner whether an authorized delivery route is permitted.

B. The system owner must approve it first. I also need to verify its actual entitlements, because the role name alone does not confirm that download is included.

C. Let us identify the required permission first. Which report are you downloading, and do you need to change anything in the system?

D. In this process they have different responsibilities. The manager confirms the need, and the system owner is the approver for the system role.

Answers and explanations, page 124

A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / CLOUD, INFRASTRUCTURE, AND COST-AWARE OPERATIONS

Compare incomplete estimates and qualify a recommendation without inventing missing costs.

> **The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage**
>
> Two monthly cloud planning estimates cover the same application. Option A is $800 and excludes backup storage. Option B is $1,050 and includes backup storage. Transfer charges and support coverage have not been confirmed for either option. Jordan prepares the comparison; Sal owns infrastructure planning. These are fictional estimates, not provider prices. No purchasing decision has been approved.

People: Jordan, Cloud operations analyst; Sal, Infrastructure planning lead.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which cost difference is confirmed?

A. Both quotes cover identical items.
B. Only Option B includes backup storage.
C. Option A includes all support.
D. Transfer charges are zero for both.

2. What is the headline difference?

A. No difference
B. $250 per month
C. $1,850 per month
D. $800 per year

3. Which conclusion is premature?

A. Option A omits backup storage.
B. No purchase is approved.
C. Option A is the cheaper complete solution.
D. Option B's estimate is $1,050.

Answers and explanations, page 125

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

cloud service
Computing capability delivered through a service model.

compare cloud services

infrastructure
The underlying computing and network resources.

plan infrastructure capacity

instance
A running or configured unit of computing capacity.

size a compute instance

virtual machine
A software-defined computing environment emulating a machine.

provision a virtual machine

region
A provider-defined geographical deployment area.

choose an approved region

availability zone
A provider-defined location grouping within a region.

compare availability-zone designs

object storage
Storage that manages data as objects with metadata.

estimate object-storage usage

block storage
Storage presented as addressable blocks.

size block-storage volumes

snapshot
A point-in-time representation of data or system state.

document a snapshot policy

backup
A retained copy intended to support recovery.

include backup storage

retention period
The length of time data is kept.

confirm the retention period

restore test
A check that retained data can be recovered as required.

schedule a restore test

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

cloud service CLOUD SERVICE

compare cloud services

Keep the meaning precise: Computing capability delivered through a service model.

availability zone AVAILABILITY ZONE

compare availability-zone designs

Keep the meaning precise: A provider-defined location grouping within a region.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

RPO
Recovery point objective; tolerated data-loss interval.

agree on the RPO

RTO
Recovery time objective; target time to restore service.

agree on the RTO

egress
Data leaving a defined network or service boundary.

estimate egress charges

ingress
Data entering a defined network or service boundary.

identify ingress traffic

consumption
Measured resource use over a period.

forecast resource consumption

reservation
A commitment or capacity allocation under stated terms.

compare reservation terms

on-demand
Resource use without the particular advance commitment being discussed.

estimate on-demand usage

right-sizing
Matching resource allocation to workload needs.

assess right-sizing options

cost allocation
Assignment of expenses to services or owners.

document cost allocation

line item
An individual entry in an estimate or bill.

compare each line item

exclusion
A cost or service left outside the stated scope.

disclose estimate exclusions

total cost
Combined cost under explicitly defined inclusions.

compare like-for-like total cost

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

restore test RESTORE TEST

schedule a restore test

Keep the meaning precise: A check that retained data can be recovered as required.

consumption CONSUMPTION

forecast resource consumption

Keep the meaning precise: Measured resource use over a period.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Identify the mismatch

The estimates do not include the same services.

State the known difference

Option A excludes backup storage; Option B includes it.

Limit the arithmetic

The headline difference is $250, not a confirmed like-for-like saving.

Request a common basis

Can we compare both options against the same workload and retention assumptions?

Keep uncertainty visible

Transfer charges remain unconfirmed for both options.

Ask about coverage

Does support cover the hours and response level we need?

Separate cost and recovery

Including storage does not establish that restoration has been tested.

Bound the recommendation

I cannot recommend the lower total until the missing items are priced.

Check a unit

Is that per month, per stored unit, or per transfer volume?

Expose an assumption

Which usage pattern does this estimate assume?

Ask about commitments

What term or minimum spend is attached to that figure?

Preserve exclusions

Put the excluded items next to the headline total.

Avoid invented numbers

I will mark the amount unknown rather than enter zero.

Clarify an objective

Is that the tolerated data-loss interval or the restoration-time target?

Compare sensitivity

Show how the estimate changes under the agreed higher-use scenario.

Close the comparison

We will reconcile the scope before asking for a purchasing decision.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Request a common basis
Useful wording: Can we compare both options against the same workload and retention assumptions?

Purpose: Keep uncertainty visible
Useful wording: Transfer charges remain unconfirmed for both options.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which comparison is defensible now?

A. A is $250 lower before its missing backup and other unconfirmed costs are resolved.
B. A saves exactly $250 for equivalent coverage.
C. B costs $250 more solely because its service is better.
D. Transfer costs are included because no amount is shown.

2. How should an unconfirmed transfer charge appear?

A. Zero, because nobody has quoted it
B. Included, because cloud services usually bundle everything
C. Irrelevant, because the headline is monthly
D. Unknown, with the required assumption identified

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A software-defined computing environment emulating a machine. Which term fits?

A. snapshot
B. egress
C. cost allocation
D. virtual machine

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage". Jordan: "I will request the missing backup amount. Should I put zero against transfer charges until the provider confirms them, so the spreadsheet totals correctly?" Sal: [missing response] Jordan: "Understood. The workload estimate also assumes the current data volume. We expect growth, but the higher-use scenario has not been agreed with the application owner." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Obtain that assumption before adjusting the figure. Compare consumption on the same basis for both options rather than quietly giving one a smaller workload.

B. Before recommending it, compare the inclusions. I see backup storage in B, but not in A. Are they priced on the same basis?

C. No. Mark them unknown and record the assumed traffic. A working formula should not turn an unanswered pricing question into a free service.

D. Storage and recoverability are different. Ask about the agreed retention period, recovery requirements, and the process for checking restoration under the approved plan.

Answers and explanations, page 125

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The $250 difference compares two headline estimates with different inclusions. It is not a verified saving for equivalent services. RPO describes a data-loss interval; RTO describes a restoration-time target.

E Conversation

The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage

The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

consumption / line item / commitment / unknown / audit trail / RPO / headline difference / like-for-like / retention period / inclusions

01 **Jordan:** Option A is $800 a month and Option B is $1,050. I was going to recommend A as a $250 monthly saving for the application.

02 **Sal:** Before recommending it, compare the [1] _____. I see backup storage in B, but not in A. Are they priced on the same basis?

03 **Jordan:** Not yet. A's estimate explicitly excludes backup storage. I also have not confirmed transfer charges or support coverage for either option, so the comparison is incomplete.

04 **Sal:** Then $250 is the [2] _____, not an established saving. We should keep the arithmetic but qualify what it means.

05 **Jordan:** I will request the missing backup amount. Should I put zero against transfer charges until the provider confirms them, so the spreadsheet totals correctly?

06 **Sal:** No. Mark them [3] _____ and record the assumed traffic. A working formula should not turn an unanswered pricing question into a free service.

07 **Jordan:** Understood. The workload estimate also assumes the current data volume. We expect growth, but the higher-use scenario has not been agreed with the application owner.

08 **Sal:** Obtain that assumption before adjusting the figure. Compare [4] _____ on the same basis for both options rather than quietly giving one a smaller workload.

09 **Jordan:** For backups, is matching the storage amount enough? B includes a line for retained copies, but I have not seen evidence of a restore test.

10 **Sal:** Storage and recoverability are different. Ask about the agreed [5] _____, recovery requirements, and the process for checking restoration under the approved plan.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Jordan:** The application owner mentioned an RPO and an RTO. I want to make sure I ask the right question rather than using those labels interchangeably.

12 **Sal:** The [6] _____ concerns how much recent data loss is tolerable. RTO concerns the target restoration time. Confirm both with the authorized owner.

13 **Jordan:** I will also check whether either price assumes a long commitment. A may be an on-demand estimate, while B may rely on an advance reservation.

14 **Sal:** Exactly. Any [7] _____ belongs beside the monthly figure. A lower unit rate can involve obligations that change the decision.

15 **Jordan:** What about support? The summary says support available, but it does not specify coverage hours or which incidents receive the quoted response level.

16 **Sal:** Treat that as another [8] _____ needing clarification. Availability is not the same as included coverage that meets this application's needs.

17 **Jordan:** I'll hold the recommendation. For today's note, I'll show the two prices and the missing items, with provisional above the totals.

18 **Sal:** Yes. We are aiming for [9] _____ totals and clearly stated differences. We do not need to pretend the two options are identical if meaningful differences remain.

19 **Jordan:** I'll put the inclusions and unresolved amounts in one table. Can we review it again when the provider answers the backup and support questions?

20 **Sal:** Good. That creates an [10] _____ for the recommendation. We can explain what changed when the final numbers arrive instead of defending a saving we never actually verified.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. inclusions / **2.** headline difference / **3.** unknown / **4.** consumption / **5.** retention period / **6.** RPO / **7.** commitment / **8.** line item / **9.** like-for-like / **10.** audit trail

Why these answers fit, page 126

F Check accuracy and scope

The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage

Return to the case

Two monthly cloud planning estimates cover the same application. Option A is $800 and excludes backup storage. Option B is $1,050 and includes backup storage. Transfer charges and support coverage have not been confirmed for either option. Jordan prepares the comparison; Sal owns infrastructure planning. These are fictional estimates, not provider prices. No purchasing decision has been approved.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which question concerns RPO?

A. How long must retained backup copies be kept?
B. How many gigabytes does the backup repository hold?
C. How far back may the recovered data point be relative to the disruption?
D. How quickly must the service be restored?

2. What does included backup storage fail to establish?

A. That storage is in the quoted scope
B. That the quote contains a backup line
C. That the estimate is monthly
D. That a successful restore has been tested

Answers and explanations, page 128

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Ask for missing backup, transfer and support terms; keep unknown charges distinct from zero.

Comparable totals require comparable scope

A low headline figure can be accurate yet unsuitable for a decision when inclusions differ. Identify missing line items without accusing the estimator of deception. Ask for a like-for-like comparison and keep unknown amounts unknown.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

An annual software quote excludes migration

Quote A is $12,000 annually without migration support. Quote B is $14,000 with migration support. The required migration scope and any additional charges remain unconfirmed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

unknown / exclusion / like-for-like / scope

01 **Analyst:** The $2,000 difference compares unequal [1] _____.

02 **Manager:** List migration as an [2] _____ from A, not an assumed free service.

03 **Analyst:** I will keep the additional amount marked [3] _____ until it is confirmed.

04 **Manager:** Then request a [4] _____ comparison before recommending a purchase.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. scope / **2.** exclusion / **3.** unknown / **4.** like-for-like

Why these answers fit, page 128

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage". Jordan: "I will also check whether either price assumes a long commitment. A may be an on-demand estimate, while B may rely on an advance reservation." Sal: [missing response] Jordan: "What about support? The summary says support available, but it does not specify coverage hours or which incidents receive the quoted response level." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Then $250 is the headline difference, not an established saving. We should keep the arithmetic but qualify what it means.

B. Exactly. Any commitment belongs beside the monthly figure. A lower unit rate can involve obligations that change the decision.

C. Treat that as another line item needing clarification. Availability is not the same as included coverage that meets this application's needs.

D. The RPO concerns how much recent data loss is tolerable. RTO concerns the target restoration time. Confirm both with the authorized owner.

Answers and explanations, page 129

Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Identity, Access, and Permissions" and "Cloud, Infrastructure, and Cost-Aware Operations". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Permission to perform an action on a resource. Which term fits?

A. SSO
B. authorization
C. administrator
D. access request

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Storage presented as addressable blocks. Which term fits?

A. block storage
B. on-demand
C. cloud service
D. RPO

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis". Eli: "Understood. I will ask whether all four people use the same VPN profile. If they do, that may help us narrow where to compare the configuration." Nia: [missing response] Eli: "If the lookup gives the same address on both paths, should we remove DNS from the report completely and say it is definitely the firewall?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The access-path pattern is useful, but DNS is still a hypothesis. What result distinguishes name resolution from routing or an access-policy issue?
B. Good. The comparison should show what differs and what remains unchanged. That gives the next team something concrete to investigate.
C. Then ask for the exact symptom. A timeout, a refusal, and a certificate warning should not be recorded as the same observation.
D. Yes, and include the source network and hostname. We want comparable requests, not a working office test against a different address.

Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage". Jordan: "I'll hold the recommendation. For today's note, I'll show the two prices and the missing items, with provisional above the totals." Sal: [missing response] Jordan: "I'll put the inclusions and unresolved amounts in one table. Can we review it again when the provider answers the backup and support questions?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Before recommending it, compare the inclusions. I see backup storage in B, but not in A. Are they priced on the same basis?

B. Good. That creates an audit trail for the recommendation. We can explain what changed when the final numbers arrive instead of defending a saving we never actually verified.

C. Obtain that assumption before adjusting the figure. Compare consumption on the same basis for both options rather than quietly giving one a smaller workload.

D. Yes. We are aiming for like-for-like totals and clearly stated differences. We do not need to pretend the two options are identical if meaningful differences remain.

Answers and explanations, page 153

A Read the situation

LESSON 05 / ENDPOINTS, SERVERS, PATCHING, AND CONFIGURATION MANAGEMENT

Report deployment states accurately and define evidence needed for completion.

Ninety percent installed is not complete

A patch was assigned to 200 managed laptops. The console reports successful installation on 180, twelve laptops were offline, and eight returned installation errors. Post-installation verification has not been completed on all successful devices. Arun manages endpoints; Casey coordinates the rollout. A manager asks whether the deployment is complete. There is no approved exception for the remaining twenty laptops.

People: Arun, Endpoint administrator; Casey, Rollout coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. How many laptops report successful installation?

A. 188
B. 180
C. 200
D. 192

2. What is known about the remaining twenty?

A. All twenty were removed from the inventory.
B. Twelve were offline and eight returned errors.
C. All twenty are approved exceptions.
D. All twenty passed verification.

3. Why is complete premature?

A. Every installation has failed.
B. The console cannot show counts.
C. Not all devices are installed and verified under the stated criteria.
D. The patch has not been assigned to any device.

Answers and explanations, page 130

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

endpoint
A user device or other terminal system on a network.

manage an endpoint

asset inventory
A record of devices and their relevant attributes.

reconcile the asset inventory

patch level
The installed state of relevant software updates.

confirm the patch level

installation
Placement and setup of software on a system.

confirm installation status

reboot
Restarting a system.

identify a pending reboot

offline
Not currently connected or available to the management system.

identify offline devices

managed device
A device enrolled under an organization's management controls.

verify the managed-device inventory

patch
A software update intended to correct or change behavior.

deploy an approved patch

deployment
Distribution and application of a configuration or update.

track deployment progress

verification
Checking evidence that the required state has been achieved.

complete post-installation verification

maintenance window
An approved period for planned service work.

schedule a maintenance window

retry
Another attempt after an earlier incomplete or failed action.

schedule an authorized retry

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

endpoint ENDPOINT

manage an endpoint

Keep the meaning precise: A user device or other terminal system on a network.

deployment DEPLOYMENT

track deployment progress

Keep the meaning precise: Distribution and application of a configuration or update.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

error code
A code identifying a reported error condition.
group installation error codes

compliance state
A device's status against defined requirements.
report the compliance state

configuration baseline
The agreed reference configuration.
compare with the configuration baseline

configuration drift
Difference from the expected configuration over time.
detect configuration drift

exception
An approved departure from a requirement under stated conditions.
document an approved exception

remediation
Work to correct a deficiency or failure.
assign remediation ownership

deployment ring
A defined group receiving a staged rollout.
review a deployment ring

pilot group
A limited group used to test a change before expansion.
validate the pilot group

supersedence
Replacement of an earlier update by another.
check patch supersedence

dependency
A prerequisite needed for another action to succeed.
verify installation dependencies

rollback
Return to an earlier configuration or version.
confirm rollback readiness

completion criterion
A condition defining when work counts as complete.
state the completion criterion

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

retry RETRY

schedule an authorized retry

Keep the meaning precise: Another attempt after an earlier incomplete or failed action.

exception EXCEPTION

document an approved exception

Keep the meaning precise: An approved departure from a requirement under stated conditions.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Report the counts

Installation succeeded on 180 of 200 managed laptops.

Qualify completion

Verification is not yet complete on all reported successes.

Preserve the denominator

The planned scope remains 200 devices unless a change is approved.

Ask for error evidence

Which error codes are shared across the eight failures?

Check a restart

Does the required state depend on a pending reboot?

Name the criterion

What evidence must every in-scope device provide for completion?

Clarify a retry

A retry is scheduled; its outcome is not yet known.

Track recovery

Keep the approved rollback route available during the rollout.

Separate remaining states

Twelve were offline; eight returned installation errors.

Reject an overstatement

I would report progress, not mark the deployment complete.

Distinguish an exception

Offline status is not an approved exception.

Set the next action

Assign owners for the offline follow-up, errors, and verification.

Avoid a false category

Keep installation failure separate from devices we could not reach.

Limit the percentage

Ninety percent installed does not mean the full rollout is verified.

Record a change

Any removal from scope needs a documented reason and approval.

Close honestly

The next update will show verified devices and each unresolved group.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Reject an overstatement
Useful wording: I would report progress, not mark the deployment complete.

Purpose: Preserve the denominator
Useful wording: The planned scope remains 200 devices unless a change is approved.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which status statement is accurate?

A. 180 installed; twelve offline; eight errors; verification still in progress.

B. Deployment complete because 90 percent installed.

C. All twenty unresolved devices are approved exceptions.

D. All 200 devices have failed verification.

2. What percentage reports successful installation?

A. 10 percent

B. 94 percent

C. 96 percent

D. 90 percent

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A software update intended to correct or change behavior. Which term fits?

A. patch

B. configuration baseline

C. reboot

D. supersedence

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Ninety percent installed is not complete". Casey: "What should we call the twelve offline laptops? They may simply belong to people who were away. I do not want to count them as failed installations." Arun: [missing response] Casey: "Someone suggested excluding the offline devices from the total for now. That would make the progress figure look closer to the target while we contact their owners." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep them in an offline group. They remain in scope, but their status differs from the eight devices that actually returned installation errors.

B. Not yet. We need to distinguish installation from verification. Twelve devices were offline and eight returned errors, so twenty still lack successful installation reports.

C. Record any pending reboot separately under the approved process. We should not describe a device as verified while a required state transition remains unfinished.

D. Review the error codes first. A shared count can hide different causes, and a scheduled retry is not evidence that the installation will complete.

Answers and explanations, page 130

One useful distinction

Assigned, downloaded, installed, restarted, and verified are not synonyms. A successful installation report may still require a restart or verification under the approved procedure. Report the actual evidence, not the most optimistic label.

E Conversation

Ninety percent installed is not complete

Ninety percent installed is not complete

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

installation / error codes / remediation / offline / denominator / completion criterion / reboot / exception / criteria / inventory

01 **Casey:** The manager wants to know whether the laptop deployment is complete. The console shows 180 successes out of 200. Can I mark the rollout done?

02 **Arun:** Not yet. We need to distinguish [1] _____ from verification. Twelve devices were offline and eight returned errors, so twenty still lack successful installation reports.

03 **Casey:** I could say ninety percent complete and list the remaining devices underneath. Would that be clearer than calling the whole deployment finished for the manager?

04 **Arun:** Say ninety percent report installed. Our [2] _____ also includes verification, and that check has not finished on every reported success.

05 **Casey:** What should we call the twelve offline laptops? They may simply belong to people who were away. I do not want to count them as failed installations.

06 **Arun:** Keep them in an [3] _____ group. They remain in scope, but their status differs from the eight devices that actually returned installation errors.

07 **Casey:** Someone suggested excluding the offline devices from the total for now. That would make the progress figure look closer to the target while we contact their owners.

08 **Arun:** The [4] _____ remains 200 unless an approved scope change says otherwise. Being inconvenient to reach is not a reason to remove a device from the report.

09 **Casey:** Understood. For the eight errors, do we have enough information to promise a successful retry today, or do we need a separate technical review first?

10 **Arun:** Review the [5] _____ first. A shared count can hide different causes, and a scheduled retry is not evidence that the installation will complete.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Ninety percent installed is not complete

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Casey:** I will ask for owners and next actions for both groups. What about the successful devices that still need a restart before their new state takes effect?

12 **Arun:** Record any pending [6] _____ separately under the approved process. We should not describe a device as verified while a required state transition remains unfinished.

13 **Casey:** If a laptop cannot be updated during this window because of a documented application dependency, can the team mark it as an exception in the report?

14 **Arun:** Only after the authorized [7] _____ decision. Record the reason, owner, and review condition; do not convert an unresolved error into an approved departure automatically.

15 **Casey:** I'll show those states separately. But can a device be both installed and pending verification? I don't want the totals to exceed two hundred.

16 **Arun:** Yes. Pending verification can be a subset of the installed group, not extra devices to add to it. Reconcile the [8] _____ and state which counts overlap.

17 **Casey:** Can you send the verified count before this afternoon's review, with an owner for each outstanding group? That's what the manager will ask for.

18 **Arun:** Yes. I will include the current evidence and [9] _____ status. Where an action depends on a user or another team, I will make that dependency visible.

19 **Casey:** Then my message will say installation is progressing, twenty devices lack success reports, verification remains open, and no exception has been approved for those twenty.

20 **Arun:** That is accurate. We will close the rollout only when the agreed [10] _____ are met or an authorized scope decision changes them. Clear state labels let the manager decide without being misled by done.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. installation / **2.** completion criterion / **3.** offline / **4.** denominator / **5.** error codes / **6.** reboot / **7.** exception / **8.** inventory / **9.** remediation / **10.** criteria

Why these answers fit, page 131

F Check accuracy and scope

Ninety percent installed is not complete

Return to the case

A patch was assigned to 200 managed laptops. The console reports successful installation on 180, twelve laptops were offline, and eight returned installation errors. Post-installation verification has not been completed on all successful devices. Arun manages endpoints; Casey coordinates the rollout. A manager asks whether the deployment is complete. There is no approved exception for the remaining twenty laptops.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which action would distort the report?

A. Recording verification as pending
B. Naming an owner for follow-up
C. Removing offline devices from scope without an approved change
D. Listing the error group separately

2. Which statement describes a plan rather than a result?

A. No exception has been approved.
B. A retry is scheduled for the eight errors.
C. The console records 180 successes.
D. Twelve devices were offline.

Answers and explanations, page 133

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Treat pending verification as a possible subset of installed devices, not extra inventory; retain the approved 200-device scope.

Use state labels that preserve remaining work

A broad word such as done can hide devices that were offline, failed, or still require verification. Report mutually understandable states and counts. Do not describe a percentage as completion unless the agreed criteria actually permit it.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

A server update is installed but not verified

An approved server update reports successful installation. A required restart is pending, and the service check has not run. The maintenance owner must receive an accurate status.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

reboot / complete / verification / criteria

01 **Engineer:** Installation is reported successful, but a [1] _____ is still pending.

02 **Owner:** Then the service check is still part of [2] _____.

03 **Engineer:** I will describe the update as in progress, not [3] _____.

04 **Owner:** Keep the approved recovery route available until the [4] _____ are met.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. reboot / **2.** verification / **3.** complete / **4.** criteria

Why these answers fit, page 133

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Ninety percent installed is not complete". Casey: "If a laptop cannot be updated during this window because of a documented application dependency, can the team mark it as an exception in the report?" Arun: [missing response] Casey: "I'll show those states separately. But can a device be both installed and pending verification? I don't want the totals to exceed two hundred." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Only after the authorized exception decision. Record the reason, owner, and review condition; do not convert an unresolved error into an approved departure automatically.

B. Not yet. We need to distinguish installation from verification. Twelve devices were offline and eight returned errors, so twenty still lack successful installation reports.

C. Review the error codes first. A shared count can hide different causes, and a scheduled retry is not evidence that the installation will complete.

D. Record any pending reboot separately under the approved process. We should not describe a device as verified while a required state transition remains unfinished.

Answers and explanations, page 134

A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / SECURITY OPERATIONS, RISK, AND INCIDENT RESPONSE

Escalate a security observation with urgency, accurate scope, and controlled evidence.

> **An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise**
>
> An alert flags an unusual sign-in for a staff account at 09:12 UTC. The account owner has not confirmed whether the activity was legitimate. No data-access review has occurred. Bea detected the alert; Tomas coordinates the authorized response team. The team has a restricted evidence channel and an on-call contact. Only authorized responders decide containment actions in this fictional organization.

People: Bea, Security monitoring analyst; Tomas, Incident response coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is confirmed?

A. An unusual-sign-in alert occurred at 09:12 UTC.
B. The account is compromised.
C. Customer data was stolen.
D. The account owner approved the activity.

2. Who decides containment under this case's process?

A. The account owner without review
B. Authorized responders
C. Any message recipient
D. The alert's wording alone

3. Where should detailed evidence be placed?

A. A personal mailbox so it is separate from the affected system
B. Any shared folder once the account name is removed
C. The approved restricted evidence channel
D. A broad project chat because no breach is confirmed yet

Answers and explanations, page 135

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

alert
A signal that a condition may require attention.
triage an alert

event
An observed occurrence in a system.
correlate security events

indicator
A piece of information that may point to relevant activity.
assess an indicator

compromise
Unauthorized access or loss of a system's trusted state.
investigate suspected compromise

breach
A security or privacy violation whose exact meaning depends on context.
avoid an unverified breach claim

false positive
An alert or finding that identifies a condition not actually present.
investigate a possible false positive

sign-in log
A record of authentication attempts or sessions.
preserve the sign-in log

session
A period or context of authenticated interaction.
review the account session

geolocation
An estimate of geographical position from available signals.
qualify a geolocation estimate

anomaly
A departure from an expected pattern.
assess a sign-in anomaly

SOC
Security operations center; a function coordinating monitoring and response.
notify the SOC

on-call
Assigned availability to respond during a defined period.
contact the on-call responder

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

alert ALERT

triage an alert

Keep the meaning precise: A signal that a condition may require attention.

false positive FALSE POSITIVE

investigate a possible false positive

Keep the meaning precise: An alert or finding that identifies a condition not actually present.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

escalation threshold

A condition requiring referral or higher attention.

apply the escalation threshold

containment

Actions intended to limit an incident's consequences.

assign containment authority

eradication

Removal of identified causes or malicious elements under a response process.

distinguish eradication from containment

recovery

Restoration of services or operations after disruption.

coordinate recovery communication

evidence preservation

Keeping relevant records intact for authorized review.

follow evidence-preservation requirements

chain of custody

A record of evidence handling and transfers.

maintain chain of custody

timeline

An ordered account of events with times.

build an incident timeline

scope assessment

Determination of affected assets, accounts, or data.

conduct a scope assessment

severity

The assessed seriousness of an incident or finding.

review incident severity

notification

Communication to designated recipients under defined rules.

confirm notification ownership

need to know

A principle restricting information to necessary recipients.

share on a need-to-know basis

post-incident review

Examination of an incident and lessons after response.

schedule a post-incident review

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

on-call ON-CALL

contact the on-call responder

Keep the meaning precise: Assigned availability to respond during a defined period.

evidence preservation EVIDENCE PRESERVATION

follow evidence-preservation requirements

Keep the meaning precise: Keeping relevant records intact for authorized review.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Lead with the event

An unusual-sign-in alert was recorded at 09:12 UTC.

Escalate promptly

I am referring this through the approved response channel now.

Protect the record

The complete evidence is in the restricted channel.

Preserve timing

Keep the original timestamp and its time zone in the timeline.

Qualify location

The alert reports a location estimate, not verified physical travel.

Limit distribution

Share account details only with the designated recipients.

Record a handoff

Please confirm who has accepted response ownership.

Preserve evidence

Follow the approved handling process before altering relevant records.

State the unknown

The account owner has not yet confirmed the activity.

Avoid a premature label

We have not established compromise or data exposure.

Name the authority

The authorized responder will decide containment actions.

Set the next update

The next update will distinguish confirmed findings from open questions.

Check scope

Which accounts and assets have actually been reviewed?

Avoid reassurance without evidence

An unconfirmed alert is not the same as a cleared alert.

Separate decisions

Technical response and external notification have different owners.

Close accurately

The finding remains under review; no final classification has been made.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Avoid a premature label
Useful wording: We have not established compromise or data exposure.

Purpose: Protect the record
Useful wording: The complete evidence is in the restricted channel.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which initial report is accurate?

A. Confirmed account takeover with stolen customer data.

B. False positive because nobody has confirmed it.

C. Incident closed because an alert is not proof.

D. Unusual-sign-in alert at 09:12 UTC; owner confirmation and scope review pending.

2. What does "owner confirmation pending" establish?

A. The account was definitely stolen.

B. Confirmation has not been completed.

C. The owner denies the activity.

D. The owner approves the activity.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Unauthorized access or loss of a system's trusted state. Which term fits?

A. severity

B. compromise

C. geolocation

D. eradication

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise". Bea: "The alert includes a location estimate that differs from the user's usual pattern. I have not checked whether travel or another legitimate explanation could account for it." Tomas: [missing response] Bea: "I also have not reviewed subsequent data access. I will leave impact unknown rather than saying no data was accessed just because that field is empty." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep that geolocation limitation explicit. Do not report physical travel as fact, and do not dismiss the event merely because a benign explanation is possible.

B. Use suspected activity and the confirmed alert details. Urgency does not require an unsupported conclusion. The escalation route communicates the need for attention.

C. That is the right distinction. Keep the finding under review until the authorized decision is recorded, and preserve the evidence and uncertainty in every shortened update.

D. Refer notification decisions to the designated owner. Do not invent a legal threshold, promise no notification, or make a public statement from this initial signal.

Answers and explanations, page 135

> **One useful distinction**
>
> An alert is a signal to assess, not automatic proof of compromise. A location estimate is not proof of a person's physical location. Preserve the difference between observed evidence, an interpretation, and an authorized classification.

E Conversation

An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise

An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

geolocation / under review / scope assessment / classification / need-to-know / notification / containment / alert / timeline / restricted channel

01 **Bea:** An unusual-sign-in alert fired for a staff account at 09:12 UTC. I have the event record, but the account owner has not confirmed the activity yet.

02 **Tomas:** Please escalate through the approved route and place the full record in the [1] _____. We need prompt review without sending account details to everyone in the project chat.

03 **Bea:** Should the subject say confirmed compromise so the on-call responder treats it urgently? I do not want a qualified title to make this seem unimportant.

04 **Tomas:** Use suspected activity and the confirmed [2] _____ details. Urgency does not require an unsupported conclusion. The escalation route communicates the need for attention.

05 **Bea:** The alert includes a location estimate that differs from the user's usual pattern. I have not checked whether travel or another legitimate explanation could account for it.

06 **Tomas:** Keep that [3] _____ limitation explicit. Do not report physical travel as fact, and do not dismiss the event merely because a benign explanation is possible.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Bea:** I also have not reviewed subsequent data access. I will leave impact unknown rather than saying no data was accessed just because that field is empty.

08 **Tomas:** Correct. Missing review is not a negative finding. The responder needs a [4] _____ before making claims about affected data or other accounts.

09 **Bea:** Who decides whether any containment action is needed? I can preserve the alert, but I am not authorized to make changes to the account in this process.

10 **Tomas:** The authorized response team owns [5] _____. I will confirm the named responder has accepted the handoff rather than assume that receiving a message means someone is acting.

Conversation continues on the next page.

An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Bea:** I will preserve the original record and use a redacted summary for the wider operational update. The timestamp will remain 09:12 UTC in both places.

12 **Tomas:** Good. Consistent timing supports the [6] _____. Follow the evidence-handling process so the original information remains available and its history is clear.

13 **Bea:** If the owner later says the activity was theirs, can I close the alert immediately, or does the response team need to review that confirmation first?

14 **Tomas:** Follow the assigned review route. Confirmation is evidence, but the authorized reviewer decides the [7] _____ using the whole record and the organization's criteria.

15 **Bea:** Understood. The business lead is already asking whether we must notify customers. I do not have enough information to answer that, and no data review is complete.

16 **Tomas:** Refer [8] _____ decisions to the designated owner. Do not invent a legal threshold, promise no notification, or make a public statement from this initial signal.

17 **Bea:** I'll send the business lead a short status update: who has the case, which checks are running, and what we still don't know. No account details.

18 **Tomas:** Exactly. Use a [9] _____ summary for the audience. Clear communication does not mean every recipient receives every piece of evidence.

19 **Bea:** I'll submit it now. If the on-call responder hasn't accepted it, I'll follow the escalation route rather than leave it in the queue.

20 **Tomas:** That is the right distinction. Keep the finding [10] _____ until the authorized decision is recorded, and preserve the evidence and uncertainty in every shortened update.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. restricted channel / **2.** alert / **3.** geolocation / **4.** scope assessment / **5.** containment / **6.** timeline / **7.** classification / **8.** notification / **9.** need-to-know / **10.** under review

Why these answers fit, page 137

F Check accuracy and scope

An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise

Return to the case

An alert flags an unusual sign-in for a staff account at 09:12 UTC. The account owner has not confirmed whether the activity was legitimate. No data-access review has occurred. Bea detected the alert; Tomas coordinates the authorized response team. The team has a restricted evidence channel and an on-call contact. Only authorized responders decide containment actions in this fictional organization.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which question clarifies response ownership?

A. Who received the alert first?
B. Who forwarded the broadest status update?
C. Who has technical access, even if no response role is assigned?
D. Who has accepted responsibility for the containment decision under the approved process?

2. Which statement overclaims scope?

A. The data-access review has not occurred.
B. A restricted evidence channel is available.
C. Every account is affected because one alert fired.
D. One account generated the recorded alert.

Answers and explanations, page 138

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Preserve pending account-owner confirmation and data-access review; use the restricted evidence route.

Urgency and uncertainty can coexist

You can escalate promptly without labeling an unverified event a breach. State the alert, known facts, unanswered questions, and available evidence. An appropriately qualified report helps responders act; qualification is not a reason to delay notification.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

A suspicious email is reported but not analyzed

An employee reports a suspicious email. The attachment has not been analyzed, and no interaction has been confirmed. The approved reporting route accepts the original message for authorized review.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

confirmed / unknown / know / route

01 **Analyst:** The email is reported suspicious; malicious content is not yet [1] _____.

02 **Coordinator:** Use the approved reporting [2] _____ for the original message.

03 **Analyst:** Whether anyone interacted with it remains [3] _____.

04 **Coordinator:** Keep the wider update limited to the audience's need to [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. confirmed / **2.** route / **3.** unknown / **4.** know

Why these answers fit, page 138

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise". Bea: "If the owner later says the activity was theirs, can I close the alert immediately, or does the response team need to review that confirmation first?" Tomas: [missing response] Bea: "Understood. The business lead is already asking whether we must notify customers. I do not have enough information to answer that, and no data review is complete." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Use suspected activity and the confirmed alert details. Urgency does not require an unsupported conclusion. The escalation route communicates the need for attention.

B. Follow the assigned review route. Confirmation is evidence, but the authorized reviewer decides the classification using the whole record and the organization's criteria.

C. Correct. Missing review is not a negative finding. The responder needs a scope assessment before making claims about affected data or other accounts.

D. Keep that geolocation limitation explicit. Do not report physical travel as fact, and do not dismiss the event merely because a benign explanation is possible.

Answers and explanations, page 139

Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Endpoints, Servers, Patching, and Configuration Management" and "Security Operations, Risk, and Incident Response". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A record of devices and their relevant attributes. Which term fits?

A. asset inventory

B. verification

C. pilot group

D. compliance state

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A period or context of authenticated interaction. Which term fits?

A. timeline

B. escalation threshold

C. alert

D. session

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage". Jordan: "For backups, is matching the storage amount enough? B includes a line for retained copies, but I have not seen evidence of a restore test." Sal: [missing response] Jordan: "The application owner mentioned an RPO and an RTO. I want to make sure I ask the right question rather than using those labels interchangeably." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Obtain that assumption before adjusting the figure. Compare consumption on the same basis for both options rather than quietly giving one a smaller workload.

B. Before recommending it, compare the inclusions. I see backup storage in B, but not in A. Are they priced on the same basis?

C. No. Mark them unknown and record the assumed traffic. A working formula should not turn an unanswered pricing question into a free service.

D. Storage and recoverability are different. Ask about the agreed retention period, recovery requirements, and the process for checking restoration under the approved plan.

Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise". Bea: "I'll send the business lead a short status update: who has the case, which checks are running, and what we still don't know. No account details." Tomas: [missing response] Bea: "I'll submit it now. If the on-call responder hasn't accepted it, I'll follow the escalation route rather than leave it in the queue." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Use a need-to-know summary for the audience. Clear communication does not mean every recipient receives every piece of evidence.

B. Good. Consistent timing supports the timeline. Follow the evidence-handling process so the original information remains available and its history is clear.

C. Use suspected activity and the confirmed alert details. Urgency does not require an unsupported conclusion. The escalation route communicates the need for attention.

D. Correct. Missing review is not a negative finding. The responder needs a scope assessment before making claims about affected data or other accounts.

Answers and explanations, page 156

A Read the situation

LESSON 07 / CHANGE, RELEASE, PROBLEM, AND POST-INCIDENT COMMUNICATION

Replace an inaccurate notice, acknowledge impact, and confirm the controlling record.

> **Correct the maintenance date before users act on it**
>
> A maintenance notice sent to users says Tuesday from 8 to 9 p.m. The approved change record says Thursday from 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time. The work has not begun. One team moved its export schedule in response to the incorrect notice. Mina sent the notice; Owen owns change coordination. A correction must reach the original recipients and clearly replace the earlier message.

People: Mina, Service communications analyst; Owen, Change coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which window is approved?

A. Tuesday, 8 to 9 a.m.
B. Thursday, 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time
C. Tuesday, 8 to 9 p.m.
D. Thursday, all day

2. What actually changed?

A. The work moved from an approved Tuesday window.
B. The maintenance already happened.
C. All user exports were canceled.
D. The notice contained an error; the approved window did not change.

3. Which consequence is known?

A. Every team lost data.
B. The server failed on Tuesday.
C. Nobody acted on the notice.
D. One team moved its export schedule.

Answers and explanations, page 140

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

change record
Record describing a proposed change and its review or approval status.

consult the approved change record

change approval
Permission to carry out a specified change.

verify change approval

maintenance window
The authorized time period for planned work.

confirm the maintenance window

deployment
Introduction of a release or configuration into an environment.

distinguish release from deployment

implementation plan
The defined plan for carrying out a change.

confirm the implementation plan

stakeholder
A person or group with an interest in the outcome.

identify affected stakeholders

change owner
The role responsible for a proposed or approved change.

identify the change owner

maintenance notice
A communication of planned service work and impact.

correct a maintenance notice

release
A version or package made available under a process.

coordinate a software release

rollback plan
An approved route for returning to an earlier state.

review the rollback plan

validation
Checks that a change meets its intended requirements.

record post-change validation

recipient list
The designated audience for a message.

reconcile the recipient list

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

change record CHANGE RECORD

consult the approved change record

Keep the meaning precise: Record describing a proposed change and its review or approval status.

release RELEASE

coordinate a software release

Keep the meaning precise: A version or package made available under a process.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

correction
A statement replacing inaccurate information.
issue an explicit correction

source of truth
The agreed authoritative record for a particular fact.
name the source of truth

dependency
Work or a condition another action relies on.
identify a scheduling dependency

emergency change
A change handled under an authorized urgent process.
follow the emergency-change route

known error
A recognized problem with documented diagnostic context or handling.
document a known error

action owner
The person accountable for an agreed follow-up.
name the action owner

supersede
Replace an earlier record or statement as controlling.
supersede the earlier notice

acknowledgment
Confirmation of receipt or understanding.
request acknowledgment

change freeze
A defined restriction on changes during a period.
check the change-freeze policy

problem record
A record tracking an underlying cause or recurring issue.
open a problem record

post-implementation review
Review of a change's outcome after implementation.
conduct a post-implementation review

due date
The agreed date by which an action is expected.
confirm the action due date

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

recipient list RECIPIENT LIST
reconcile the recipient list
Keep the meaning precise: The designated audience for a message.

dependency DEPENDENCY
identify a scheduling dependency
Keep the meaning precise: Work or a condition another action relies on.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Own the error

The Tuesday date in my earlier notice was incorrect.

Replace the old record

This correction supersedes the earlier maintenance notice.

Acknowledge impact

I understand your team rescheduled an export based on that message.

Name the authority

The approved change record remains the source of truth.

Check the audience

Use the original recipient list and any known forwarded recipients.

Distinguish receipt

Acknowledging this correction does not provide change approval.

Avoid an assumption

We should not assume a second email has been read.

Separate follow-up

Review how the mismatch occurred after the immediate correction is sent.

State the approved fact

The approved window is Thursday, 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time.

Avoid a false history

The approved window has not changed; the notice was wrong.

Request confirmation

Please confirm that the corrected date has reached the affected team.

Close with an owner

I will send the correction and contact the team that already changed its schedule.

Preserve the zone

Include local branch time in the subject and body where appropriate.

Check dependencies

Which other scheduled work depended on the incorrect date?

Record the consequence

Note the export rescheduling as a known impact of the error.

Make action testable

Assign an owner to verify the notice against the approved record before sending.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Avoid a false history
Useful wording: The approved window has not changed; the notice was wrong.

Purpose: Acknowledge impact
Useful wording: I understand your team rescheduled an export based on that message.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which subject line matches the facts?

A. Maintenance moved from approved Tuesday to Thursday

B. Tuesday maintenance successfully completed

C. All future maintenance canceled

D. Correction: Thursday maintenance window; Tuesday date was incorrect

2. Which sentence identifies the controlling communication?

A. Please choose whichever message suits your team.

B. This correction supersedes the earlier notice.

C. Here is another note for your information.

D. Both dates may remain useful.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A communication of planned service work and impact. Which term fits?

A. maintenance notice

B. implementation plan

C. source of truth

D. known error

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct the maintenance date before users act on it". Mina: "Should I title the message maintenance moved to Thursday? That sounds concise, but it could imply Tuesday was once the authorized schedule, which it was not." Owen: [missing response] Mina: "I will include Thursday, eight to nine p.m., local branch time. I also need to say that the new message replaces the earlier notice in case both circulate." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. We need an explicit correction before more teams act on it. Has any work started, or is this still only a communication mismatch?

B. Thank you. Keep the correction and its audit trail. Clear replacement, accurate timing, and accountable follow-up matter more than making the original mistake disappear.

C. Exactly. Say the Tuesday date was incorrect and state the approved maintenance window. The authorization did not change; our message failed to match it.

D. Record a concrete follow-up with an action owner: verify the date, scope, and time zone against the approved record before each notice is sent.

Answers and explanations, page 140

> **One useful distinction**
>
> A mistaken notice is not automatically a changed authorization. "The date has moved" would imply an actual schedule change; "the Tuesday date was incorrect" identifies the communication error. Preserve the exact time zone.

E Conversation

Correct the maintenance date before users act on it

Correct the maintenance date before users act on it

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

dependency / source of truth / supersedes / recipient list / audit trail / maintenance window / action owner / Acknowledgment / correction / impact

01 **Mina:** I found an error in yesterday's maintenance notice. I wrote Tuesday from eight to nine, but the approved record says Thursday during that same hour.

02 **Owen:** We need an explicit [1] _____ before more teams act on it. Has any work started, or is this still only a communication mismatch?

03 **Mina:** The maintenance has not begun. One team moved its invoice export because of my notice, so there is already a scheduling consequence even without a service interruption.

04 **Owen:** Include that known [2] _____. We should correct the date and contact that team directly rather than assume the general email will resolve everything.

05 **Mina:** Should I title the message maintenance moved to Thursday? That sounds concise, but it could imply Tuesday was once the authorized schedule, which it was not.

06 **Owen:** Exactly. Say the Tuesday date was incorrect and state the approved [3] _____. The authorization did not change; our message failed to match it.

07 **Mina:** I will include Thursday, eight to nine p.m., local branch time. I also need to say that the new message replaces the earlier notice in case both circulate.

08 **Owen:** Use [4] _____. That makes the relationship explicit. Put the correct date prominently so recipients do not have to compare paragraphs to find it.

09 **Mina:** I have the original mailing list. Some managers may have forwarded the message, so the first list may not include everyone who now has the wrong date.

10 **Owen:** Reconcile the [5] _____ and ask managers to pass on the correction where needed. Do not claim that sending one email proves everyone received the right information.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Correct the maintenance date before users act on it

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Mina:** For the team that moved the export, I will apologize and ask whether the corrected window conflicts with their revised schedule. I cannot change that schedule on their behalf.

12 **Owen:** Good. Identify the [6] _____ and let its owner confirm the adjustment. Acknowledge the disruption without promising an action you do not own.

13 **Mina:** Do we need fresh change approval because I am issuing a corrected notice, or does the existing approved record remain valid for Thursday's work?

14 **Owen:** The approved record remains the [7] _____ for this case. We are correcting its communication, not requesting a different window or scope.

15 **Mina:** I'll call the export team as well. I need to know they've seen the correct time and whether it creates another scheduling problem.

16 **Owen:** Precisely. [8] _____ and authorization are different. The team's reply can confirm that they know the right time and identify remaining scheduling conflicts.

17 **Mina:** After the urgent correction, we should review how the wrong date entered the notice. I copied an earlier planning note instead of checking the approved record.

18 **Owen:** Record a concrete follow-up with an [9] _____: verify the date, scope, and time zone against the approved record before each notice is sent.

19 **Mina:** I'll send it now and call the export team next. I'll let you know this afternoon if anyone still has a conflict with Thursday.

20 **Owen:** Thank you. Keep the correction and its [10] _____. Clear replacement, accurate timing, and accountable follow-up matter more than making the original mistake disappear.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. correction / **2.** impact / **3.** maintenance window / **4.** supersedes / **5.** recipient list / **6.** dependency / **7.** source of truth / **8.** Acknowledgment / **9.** action owner / **10.** audit trail

Why these answers fit, page 141

F Check accuracy and scope

Correct the maintenance date before users act on it

Return to the case

A maintenance notice sent to users says Tuesday from 8 to 9 p.m. The approved change record says Thursday from 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time. The work has not begun. One team moved its export schedule in response to the incorrect notice. Mina sent the notice; Owen owns change coordination. A correction must reach the original recipients and clearly replace the earlier message.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What does receipt acknowledgment establish?

A. That the recipient received or understood the correction
B. That maintenance has been approved anew
C. That every forwarded recipient has read it
D. That the export has already been restored to its old schedule

2. Which follow-up is concrete and accountable?

A. Delete all evidence of the first message.
B. Name an owner to verify future notices against the approved record.
C. Ask everyone to be more careful indefinitely.
D. Assume the error cannot happen twice.

Answers and explanations, page 143

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Send the correction to the original recipients and address the known export rescheduling; do not describe a newly changed approval.

A correction needs an explicit replacement

Sending another message without identifying the error can leave two apparent sources of truth. Acknowledge the mistake, state the approved details, say which message is replaced, and address consequences already caused. Avoid implying that the authorized schedule changed when only the notice was wrong.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

A release notice lists the wrong version

A notice says version 4.2 will be deployed. The approved record specifies version 4.1. Deployment has not begun, and the approved version has not changed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

approval / truth / incorrect / supersedes

01 **Communicator:** The 4.2 reference was [1] _____; the approved version is 4.1.

02 **Coordinator:** State that the correction [2] _____ the earlier notice.

03 **Communicator:** The approved record remains the source of [3] _____.

04 **Coordinator:** Ask recipients to acknowledge the correction, not to provide new [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. incorrect / **2.** supersedes / **3.** truth / **4.** approval

Why these answers fit, page 143

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct the maintenance date before users act on it". Mina: "Do we need fresh change approval because I am issuing a corrected notice, or does the existing approved record remain valid for Thursday's work?" Owen: [missing response] Mina: "I'll call the export team as well. I need to know they've seen the correct time and whether it creates another scheduling problem." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The approved record remains the source of truth for this case. We are correcting its communication, not requesting a different window or scope.

B. Include that known impact. We should correct the date and contact that team directly rather than assume the general email will resolve everything.

C. Use supersedes. That makes the relationship explicit. Put the correct date prominently so recipients do not have to compare paragraphs to find it.

D. We need an explicit correction before more teams act on it. Has any work started, or is this still only a communication mismatch?

Answers and explanations, page 144

A Read the situation

LESSON 08 / PLATFORM, DEVOPS, OBSERVABILITY, AND KUBERNETES CONVERSATIONS

Challenge a narrow health claim and coordinate investigation around user-visible evidence.

> **Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy**
>
> The checkout service's dashboard shows normal server CPU usage. Five users report slow checkout during the last half hour. Request-duration and database-wait data have not yet been reviewed. Pat owns the application; Suri coordinates the platform team. The service runs in Kubernetes. There is no confirmed cause or approved production change. Both teams can review approved telemetry and agree on the next investigation owner.

People: Pat, Application engineer; Suri, Platform engineer.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which metric has been reviewed?

A. Database wait time
B. End-to-end checkout duration
C. Every user's network path
D. Server CPU usage

2. What do the five reports establish?

A. Kubernetes is definitely at fault.
B. The database has failed.
C. Every customer is unable to buy.
D. Five users experienced slow checkout in the reported period.

3. What is authorized now?

A. Ignore the reports until every user complains
B. Review approved telemetry and coordinate investigation ownership
C. Make any production change without review
D. Declare the incident resolved from CPU alone

Answers and explanations, page 145

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

platform
Shared technical services supporting applications.

coordinate with the platform team

DevOps
Collaborative practices linking software delivery and operations.

clarify DevOps responsibilities

Kubernetes
A platform for managing containerized workloads and services.

inspect Kubernetes workload status

cluster
A group of machines or resources managed together.

review cluster-level signals

node
A machine participating in a Kubernetes cluster.

inspect node resource usage

pod
A Kubernetes unit containing one or more containers.

check pod readiness

container
An isolated execution environment packaged with application dependencies.

inspect container logs

deployment
A Kubernetes resource managing a desired set of replicated pods.

review the deployment status

service
In Kubernetes, an abstraction exposing a group of endpoints.

inspect the service endpoints

ingress
A resource defining external HTTP or HTTPS routing to services.

review ingress routing

readiness
Whether an instance is ready to receive service traffic.

check readiness status

liveness
Whether a running instance should be considered alive under its check.

distinguish liveness from readiness

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

platform PLATFORM

coordinate with the platform team

Keep the meaning precise: Shared technical services supporting applications.

pod POD

check pod readiness

Keep the meaning precise: A Kubernetes unit containing one or more containers.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

replica
A copy of an application instance maintained for a workload.

compare replica behavior

resource request
A declared resource amount used in scheduling decisions.

review resource requests

resource limit
A configured ceiling governing resource use.

inspect resource limits

CPU
Central processing unit; processing capacity measured by the panel.

inspect CPU utilization

observability
Ability to understand system behavior from emitted signals.

improve service observability

metric
A numerical measurement collected over time.

correlate service metrics

log
A recorded event or message from a system.

review application logs

trace
A connected record of a request across components.

follow a distributed trace

span
A timed operation within a distributed trace.

identify a slow span

saturation
Capacity pressure at the most constrained resource, often reflected in waits.

investigate resource saturation

database wait
Time spent awaiting a database resource or response.

measure database wait time

user journey
The sequence of actions producing a user-visible outcome.

monitor the checkout user journey

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

liveness LIVENESS

distinguish liveness from readiness

Keep the meaning precise: Whether a running instance should be considered alive under its check.

observability OBSERVABILITY

improve service observability

Keep the meaning precise: Ability to understand system behavior from emitted signals.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Validate both observations

The CPU panel is normal, and users are reporting slow checkout.

Ask about the journey

Which part of checkout is slow from the user's perspective?

Avoid blame

We have not isolated the application or platform as the cause.

Name missing signals

Database wait and complete request duration remain unchecked.

Clarify a resource

By service, do you mean the user-facing checkout or the Kubernetes Service?

Check the time range

Are both dashboards showing the same interval and time zone?

Preserve authorization

Any production change still needs the approved route.

Coordinate ownership

Who will combine the two teams' findings into the next update?

Challenge the inference

That metric alone does not establish service health.

Request timing

Can we compare request durations during the reported half hour?

Follow the request

Trace the transaction across the components rather than stopping at one panel.

Assign the next review

Application will review request traces; platform will check the corresponding resource signals.

Limit a health check

Readiness passes for its configured test; that is not a full checkout result.

Separate mitigation

A proposed restart is not yet a diagnosed remedy.

Report measured impact

We have five reports; the full affected population is not yet known.

Close precisely

We will keep the issue open until user-visible behavior is assessed.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Request timing
Useful wording: Can we compare request durations during the reported half hour?

Purpose: Avoid blame
Useful wording: We have not isolated the application or platform as the cause.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which statement combines the evidence accurately?

A. The database is confirmed to be the bottleneck.

B. CPU is normal on the observed panel; checkout slowness still requires investigation.

C. CPU is normal, so every user report is false.

D. Kubernetes caused the slowdown because the service uses it.

2. Which question resolves the meaning of service in this discussion?

A. Were the timestamps converted to the same zone?

B. By service, do you mean checkout or the Kubernetes Service resource?

C. Which monitoring panel was refreshed most recently?

D. Which team owns the application's container image?

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A group of machines or resources managed together. Which term fits?

A. resource limit

B. span

C. service

D. cluster

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy". Pat: "When you say the service is ready, do you mean checkout has been tested or that the Kubernetes readiness checks are passing for its pods?" Suri: [missing response] Pat: "Thanks for separating that. I can review the application trace for a reported transaction if we can match it to a request identifier and time." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I mean the configured readiness checks pass. That is useful evidence about those checks, not proof that every checkout completes promptly.

B. A distributed trace should help us follow the path. Please preserve the exact interval and time zone so our teams compare the same events.

C. Start by clarifying the user journey. We can then compare request timing during the reported period with the corresponding platform signals.

D. Good. Inspect the relevant span, and avoid assuming that an uninstrumented interval contains no work. Missing telemetry is a limitation, not a zero-duration finding.

Answers and explanations, page 145

> **One useful distinction**
>
> A Kubernetes readiness check reports a configured condition, not universal correctness of every user transaction. CPU utilization is one metric; waiting on another component can produce slow responses without high CPU on the observed server.

E Conversation

Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy

Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

observability / change / database wait / handoff / metric / readiness / user journey / saturation / span / trace

01 **Pat:** Five users reported slow checkout in the last half hour. The platform dashboard shows normal CPU, so one colleague says the service must be healthy.

02 **Suri:** The panel can be correct without supporting that conclusion. CPU is one [1] _____, and we need evidence about the user-visible transaction rather than dismissing the reports.

03 **Pat:** I agree. I have not reviewed the request durations yet. The reports say checkout feels slow, but they do not identify whether payment or order confirmation is taking longer.

04 **Suri:** Start by clarifying the [2] _____. We can then compare request timing during the reported period with the corresponding platform signals.

05 **Pat:** When you say the service is ready, do you mean checkout has been tested or that the Kubernetes readiness checks are passing for its pods?

06 **Suri:** I mean the configured [3] _____ checks pass. That is useful evidence about those checks, not proof that every checkout completes promptly.

07 **Pat:** Thanks for separating that. I can review the application trace for a reported transaction if we can match it to a request identifier and time.

08 **Suri:** A distributed [4] _____ should help us follow the path. Please preserve the exact interval and time zone so our teams compare the same events.

09 **Pat:** If the slow operation is a database call, would normal application CPU be consistent with that? People seem to expect every slowdown to make CPU high.

10 **Suri:** It could be consistent with waiting, but we have not checked [5] _____ yet. Describe that as a hypothesis until the timing evidence actually supports it.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Pat:** Then I'll start with the slowest recorded operation. If the trace has a gap, I'll flag it rather than guess what happened there.

12 **Suri:** Good. Inspect the relevant [6] _____, and avoid assuming that an uninstrumented interval contains no work. Missing telemetry is a limitation, not a zero-duration finding.

13 **Pat:** Should we restart the pods while the investigation continues? A colleague suggested it because that helped with a different issue last month, but this cause is unknown.

14 **Suri:** A restart would be a production [7] _____. It needs the approved route and a reasoned proposal. We should not turn the previous incident's remedy into this incident's diagnosis.

15 **Pat:** I'll take the request path. What can your team check at the same time? I'd rather split the work than have us both checking everything.

16 **Suri:** We will examine corresponding resource use, workload status, and relevant [8] _____ signals under our approved access. You can focus on application timing and the exact checkout steps.

17 **Pat:** Who will combine the findings for the next update? Separate team messages might sound contradictory if one says resources are normal and another says customers are waiting.

18 **Suri:** I will coordinate the [9] _____. We can report both observations, explain their scope, and identify the next owner without declaring either team at fault.

Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy / continued

19 **Pat:** Then the issue stays open. We have five reports, not a verified total of affected users, and no confirmed cause or approved remedy at this point.

20 **Suri:** Exactly. Better [10] _____ means connecting the signals to the user outcome. We will report what the evidence establishes and what still needs investigation, even when the dashboard remains green.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. metric / **2.** user journey / **3.** readiness / **4.** trace / **5.** database wait / **6.** span / **7.** change / **8.** saturation / **9.** handoff / **10.** observability

Why these answers fit, page 146

F Check accuracy and scope

Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy

Return to the case

The checkout service's dashboard shows normal server CPU usage. Five users report slow checkout during the last half hour. Request-duration and database-wait data have not yet been reviewed. Pat owns the application; Suri coordinates the platform team. The service runs in Kubernetes. There is no confirmed cause or approved production change. Both teams can review approved telemetry and agree on the next investigation owner.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What could a distributed trace help identify?

A. The root cause solely from the name of the slowest span
B. Which recorded operation contributes to the request delay
C. The total affected user population from one sampled request
D. Whether every request without a trace completed normally

2. Which next step fits the stated authority?

A. Review approved telemetry and coordinate findings before proposing a production change.
B. Restart every component immediately without approval.
C. Close the issue because readiness passes.
D. Promise a fixed completion time without measurements.

Answers and explanations, page 148

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Name the unreviewed request-duration and database-wait evidence and coordinate the application and platform findings.

A healthy component is not a healthy journey

A dashboard can be correct and incomplete. Normal CPU describes one resource measure, not the entire user transaction. Invite application and platform evidence together instead of using a green panel to dismiss user reports or assign blame.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Readiness passes while a search request times out

A search application's readiness check passes, but an authorized test request times out. The check only tests a lightweight endpoint. The search backend has not yet been reviewed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

trace / journey / check / hypothesis

01 **Engineer:** The readiness [1] _____ passes for the lightweight endpoint.

02 **Reviewer:** That does not establish the complete search [2] _____ is healthy.

03 **Engineer:** I will inspect the request [3] _____ to locate the recorded delay.

04 **Reviewer:** Keep the backend explanation as a [4] _____ until the evidence supports it.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. check / **2.** journey / **3.** trace / **4.** hypothesis

Why these answers fit, page 148

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy". Pat: "Should we restart the pods while the investigation continues? A colleague suggested it because that helped with a different issue last month, but this cause is unknown." Suri: [missing response] Pat: "I'll take the request path. What can your team check at the same time? I'd rather split the work than have us both checking everything." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Better observability means connecting the signals to the user outcome. We will report what the evidence establishes and what still needs investigation, even when the dashboard remains green.

B. We will examine corresponding resource use, workload status, and relevant saturation signals under our approved access. You can focus on application timing and the exact checkout steps.

C. The panel can be correct without supporting that conclusion. CPU is one metric, and we need evidence about the user-visible transaction rather than dismissing the reports.

D. A restart would be a production change. It needs the approved route and a reasoned proposal. We should not turn the previous incident's remedy into this incident's diagnosis.

Answers and explanations, page 149

Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Change, Release, Problem, and Post-Incident Communication" and "Platform, DevOps, Observability, and Kubernetes Conversations". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Permission to carry out a specified change. Which term fits?

A. change approval

B. supersede

C. problem record

D. rollback plan

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A Kubernetes resource managing a desired set of replicated pods. Which term fits?

A. replica

B. platform

C. log

D. deployment

3. Rebuild the exchange from "An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise". Bea: "Who decides whether any containment action is needed? I can preserve the alert, but I am not authorized to make changes to the account in this process." Tomas: [missing response] Bea: "I will preserve the original record and use a redacted summary for the wider operational update. The timestamp will remain 09:12 UTC in both places." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep that geolocation limitation explicit. Do not report physical travel as fact, and do not dismiss the event merely because a benign explanation is possible.

B. Please escalate through the approved route and place the full record in the restricted channel. We need prompt review without sending account details to everyone in the project chat.

C. The authorized response team owns containment. I will confirm the named responder has accepted the handoff rather than assume that receiving a message means someone is acting.

D. That is the right distinction. Keep the finding under review until the authorized decision is recorded, and preserve the evidence and uncertainty in every shortened update.

Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy". Pat: "Who will combine the findings for the next update? Separate team messages might sound contradictory if one says resources are normal and another says customers are waiting." Suri: [missing response] Pat: "Then the issue stays open. We have five reports, not a verified total of affected users, and no confirmed cause or approved remedy at this point." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The panel can be correct without supporting that conclusion. CPU is one metric, and we need evidence about the user-visible transaction rather than dismissing the reports.

B. I will coordinate the handoff. We can report both observations, explain their scope, and identify the next owner without declaring either team at fault.

C. Good. Inspect the relevant span, and avoid assuming that an uninstrumented interval contains no work. Missing telemetry is a limitation, not a zero-duration finding.

D. A distributed trace should help us follow the path. Please preserve the exact interval and time zone so our teams compare the same events.

Answers and explanations, page 159

Language for the next case

The backup succeeded; the recovery exercise did not

elapsed time

Elapsed time is the interval actually taken, here from 10 a.m. to 1:20 p.m.

Ravi: Not against both objectives. We restored service, but the elapsed time was three hours and twenty minutes.

recovery point

Recovery point identifies the time represented by recovered data, not when restoration finished.

Ravi: The recovery point was 2 a.m., eight hours before the exercise started.

restore duration

Restore duration is the time spent recovering data, one part of the overall recovery time.

Ravi: The selected copy, its data timestamp, the restore duration, and the application validation results.

test record

Test record preserves the conditions, observations, and results of the recovery exercise.

Ravi: I'll show them separately in the test record. No overall green status.

dependencies

Dependencies are prerequisites or other work that the proposed corrective actions rely on.

Ravi: I'll investigate the unusable copy. The storage team will review the duration. We'll bring you options with cost and dependencies.

acceptance criteria

Acceptance criteria specify the conditions the next exercise must meet before it can pass.

Ravi: And define the acceptance criteria before rerunning it, including both objectives and the data checks.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

The backup succeeded; the recovery exercise did not

A fictional recovery exercise starts at 10 a.m. The latest usable backup represents 2 a.m. data. Service is restored at 1:20 p.m. The approved objectives are a four-hour recovery point objective and a two-hour recovery time objective.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

elapsed time / test record / restore duration / dependencies / acceptance criteria / recovery point

01 **Leah:** The backup dashboard is green. Can I mark the recovery exercise successful?

02 **Ravi:** Not against both objectives. We restored service, but the [1] _____ was three hours and twenty minutes.

03 **Leah:** Our target is two hours. Where did the extra time go?

04 **Ravi:** Most of it went into restoring the data. I have separate timings for provisioning, restoration, and application checks.

05 **Leah:** And how current was the recovered data?

06 **Ravi:** The [2] _____ was 2 a.m., eight hours before the exercise started.

07 **Leah:** So we also missed the four-hour data-loss objective.

08 **Ravi:** Yes. The job completed, but the available recovery point was older than the business requirement allows.

09 **Leah:** Can we solve that by scheduling more backups?

10 **Ravi:** That may help, but first we should check why the later copy wasn't usable. I don't want to prescribe a fix before that review.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The backup succeeded; the recovery exercise did not

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Leah:** Agreed. What evidence should go in the report?

12 **Ravi:** The selected copy, its data timestamp, the [3] _____, and the application validation results.

13 **Leah:** Were the recovered records actually checked, or did we stop when the service started?

14 **Ravi:** We checked the agreed sample and the totals for that backup. The checks passed within that defined scope.

15 **Leah:** Then the summary needs both the successful restoration and the missed objectives.

16 **Ravi:** I'll show them separately in the [4] _____. No overall green status.

17 **Leah:** Who will propose the corrective work?

18 **Ravi:** I'll investigate the unusable copy. The storage team will review the duration. We'll bring you options with cost and [5] _____.

19 **Leah:** Good. We'll choose a plan, then schedule another exercise.

20 **Ravi:** And define the [6] _____ before rerunning it, including both objectives and the data checks.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. elapsed time / **2.** recovery point / **3.** restore duration / **4.** test record / **5.** dependencies / **6.** acceptance criteria

Why these answers fit, page 162

A weekly status report confuses backup and recovery

A manager wants to report that nightly backups prove the application can recover within two hours. No timed recovery test has established that claim.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

verified / recovery / objective / performance

01 **Manager:** Can I describe two-hour recovery as [1] _____?

02 **Administrator:** Not yet. We have backup-job results, not a timed [2] _____ test.

03 **Manager:** I'll label two hours as the agreed [3] _____ instead.

04 **Administrator:** Good. The exercise will provide the missing [4] _____ evidence.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. verified / **2.** recovery / **3.** objective / **4.** performance

Why these answers fit, page 162

Keep the distinction audible

Explain a recovery-test shortfall using distinct time and data-loss measures.

Language for the next case

An employee leaves, but three workflows still use the account

cutoff

Cutoff is the specified time after which the departing employee's access must end.

Tara: The approved cutoff is Friday at five. Let's transfer the work instead of extending personal access informally.

service account

Service account means an identity for an automated process rather than a departing employee's personal identity.

Tara: I'll contact its service owner. A named service account may be appropriate, subject to the approved design and access review.

retention policy

Retention policy determines how records are kept and disposed of; departure alone does not authorize deletion.

Tara: Don't request deletion. The retention policy and any applicable hold instructions govern those records.

validation

Validation checks that the transferred workflow meets its intended requirements under the new ownership.

Tara: Run the approved validation with its new owner and delivery list. A changed owner field isn't enough.

action owner

Action owner identifies the person responsible for carrying out a particular follow-up task.

Tara: I will, with an action owner and status for each unresolved item.

handover checklist

Handover checklist records the tasks and confirmations needed to transfer responsibility without omissions.

Tara: Exactly. I'll send the handover checklist for you to confirm today.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

An employee leaves, but three workflows still use the account

An approved offboarding request ends a staff member's access at 5 p.m. Friday. A report subscription, a shared mailbox workflow, and a scheduled integration need new owners. Records must follow the organization's retention instructions.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

service account / action owner / validation / retention policy / handover checklist / cutoff

01 **Ben:** Can we leave Maya's account active for a week? Her reports still run from it.

02 **Tara:** The approved [1] _____ is Friday at five. Let's transfer the work instead of extending personal access informally.

03 **Ben:** I hadn't realized the report subscription belonged to her rather than the team.

04 **Tara:** That's one item. There's also the shared mailbox workflow and a scheduled integration. Who can take responsibility for each?

05 **Ben:** I can own the reports. Jordan can coordinate the mailbox. I don't know enough about the integration.

06 **Tara:** I'll contact its service owner. A named [2] _____ may be appropriate, subject to the approved design and access review.

07 **Ben:** Could Jordan simply use Maya's password while we sort this out?

08 **Tara:** No. We'll assign authorized access to Jordan's own identity. We need to know who performed each action.

09 **Ben:** Understood. Should I ask Maya to delete her old project files before she leaves?

10 **Tara:** Don't request deletion. The [3] _____ and any applicable hold instructions govern those records.

Conversation continues on the next page.

An employee leaves, but three workflows still use the account

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Ben:** I'll leave the records intact and identify the business owners.

12 **Tara:** Thanks. The access change and the records decision are separate tasks in the checklist.

13 **Ben:** How do we know the transferred report still works?

14 **Tara:** Run the approved [4] _____ with its new owner and delivery list. A changed owner field isn't enough.

15 **Ben:** I'll verify the report output. What happens if the integration isn't ready by Friday?

16 **Tara:** We escalate that continuity issue to the authorized owner. We don't silently cancel the access cutoff.

17 **Ben:** Please put that on the handover so the Friday team sees it.

18 **Tara:** I will, with an [5] _____ and status for each unresolved item.

19 **Ben:** Then we have three workflow transfers, one access deadline, and a separate records check.

20 **Tara:** Exactly. I'll send the [6] _____ for you to confirm today.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. cutoff / **2.** service account / **3.** retention policy / **4.** validation / **5.** action owner / **6.** handover checklist

Why these answers fit, page 164

A report arrives after its owner has left

A recurring report still shows the former employee as its owner. The new manager has not verified its recipients or output.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

recipient / validation / transfer / complete

01 **Manager:** The report arrived, so can we close the [1] _____ task?

02 **IT:** First confirm the new owner and the authorized [2] _____ list.

03 **Manager:** I'll also compare the output with the agreed [3] _____ criteria.

04 **IT:** Then record the result before marking the handover [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. transfer / **2.** recipient / **3.** validation / **4.** complete

Why these answers fit, page 164

Keep the distinction audible

Coordinate offboarding while separating identity access from business continuity.

Language for the next case

The certificate renews tonight, but nobody owns the alert

certificate

Certificate is the signed digital credential used in the portal's secure connection.

Nia: No outage is reported. The current certificate remains valid for six days, but last night's renewal failed.

validation plan

Validation plan specifies the checks needed to establish that the change works as intended.

Nia: Then add the approved TLS checks to the validation plan. A page response alone won't confirm the intended certificate is in use.

change record

Change record documents the planned work, responsibilities, checks, and relevant evidence.

Sol: Please include both in the change record so we don't fix only the certificate.

change window

Change window is the agreed period for planned service work, not a prediction of an outage.

Nia: Let's first define the change window and expected impact. Don't announce downtime we haven't established.

on-call

On-call identifies the person or team assigned to respond during the relevant period.

Nia: The infrastructure on-call contact, with application ownership listed as the escalation contact.

handoff

Handoff transfers the alert and response responsibility to a confirmed receiving owner.

Nia: Agreed. We'll close it after the renewal, endpoint checks, and a tested alert handoff.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

The certificate renews tonight, but nobody owns the alert

The customer portal's TLS certificate expires in six days. Automated renewal failed last night. The infrastructure team manages the renewal service; the application team validates the portal. No customer outage has been reported.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

change record / change window / on-call / certificate / validation plan / handoff

01 **Sol:** I received an expiry warning for the portal. Is the site already down?

02 **Nia:** No outage is reported. The current [1] _____ remains valid for six days, but last night's renewal failed.

03 **Sol:** I thought renewal was automatic. Why does this need our team?

04 **Nia:** Automation still needs monitoring and an owner when it fails. Infrastructure owns the renewal service; your team checks the application afterward.

05 **Sol:** What failed: issuance or installation?

06 **Nia:** The log shows issuance didn't complete. We haven't reached installation. I'm checking the approved renewal workflow now.

07 **Sol:** Can I tell Support there may be a planned outage?

08 **Nia:** Let's first define the [2] _____ and expected impact. Don't announce downtime we haven't established.

09 **Sol:** Fair. What do you need from us today?

10 **Nia:** Confirm the portal endpoints and a tester. We'll document the renewal result and the certificate presented by each endpoint.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The certificate renews tonight, but nobody owns the alert

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Sol:** Our health check only confirms that the page responds.

12 **Nia:** Then add the approved TLS checks to the [3] _____. A page response alone won't confirm the intended certificate is in use.

13 **Sol:** Should users ignore a browser warning if one appears during the work?

14 **Nia:** No. Route any warning through Support. We shouldn't ask users to bypass a security warning to keep working.

15 **Sol:** Who gets the next failed-renewal alert?

16 **Nia:** The infrastructure [4] _____ contact, with application ownership listed as the escalation contact.

17 **Sol:** I'll verify that contact list. The current alert reached a mailbox nobody checks overnight.

18 **Nia:** That explains the notification gap, not necessarily the renewal failure. I'll track the two issues separately.

19 **Sol:** Please include both in the [5] _____ so we don't fix only the certificate.

20 **Nia:** Agreed. We'll close it after the renewal, endpoint checks, and a tested alert [6] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. certificate / **2.** change window / **3.** validation plan / **4.** on-call / **5.** change record / **6.** handoff

Why these answers fit, page 166

Support receives a certificate-warning screenshot

A user reports a browser warning after the planned renewal. Support must gather evidence and escalate without asking the user to bypass it.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

address / owner / warning / message

01 **User:** Should I click past the [1] _____ to reach the portal?

02 **Support:** No. Please report the exact portal [2] _____ through our support channel.

03 **User:** I'll include the time and the wording of the [3] _____.

04 **Support:** I'll escalate it to the named [4] _____ and keep you updated.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. warning / **2.** address / **3.** message / **4.** owner

Why these answers fit, page 166

Keep the distinction audible

Clarify technical ownership and communicate a preventive change.

01 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which function is confirmed to fail?

D. Exporting the current month's invoices

The briefing confirms an export error while sign-in and invoice viewing still work for Ren.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A2. How many people have reported the export issue?

D. Three

Ren and two colleagues have reported it; the wider affected population is unknown.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A3. What may Asha promise?

A. An escalation and a timed update

Asha can coordinate triage and escalation, but the briefing gives no confirmed repair time or authority over billing.

Return to the exercise, page 4

D / Response choices

D1. Which ticket summary is most accurate?

C. Current-month export fails for three reported users; sign-in and viewing work for Ren.

The accurate summary preserves confirmed functions and reported scope without extending the evidence.

Return to the exercise, page 8

D2. Which statement promises communication rather than repair?

D. I will send a progress update by noon.

An update can report incomplete findings; it does not guarantee that service will be restored.

Return to the exercise, page 8

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An unplanned disruption or reduction in service. Which term fits?

D. incident

A Not here. knowledge article: A maintained support reference for a known task or issue. The usual combination is "check the knowledge article".

B Not here. resolution: Restoration or completion according to the agreed criteria. The usual combination is "confirm the resolution".

C Not here. affected user: A person experiencing the reported problem. The usual combination is "identify affected users".

D Correct. incident: An unplanned disruption or reduction in service. The usual combination is "report a service incident".

Return to the exercise, page 8

D4. Rebuild the exchange from ""The system is down" means the export fails". Ren: "Two colleagues have the same problem. We have not checked older periods or asked the other office. Does that mean it is a major outage?" Asha: [missing response] Ren: "Please do. Would a screenshot help? It shows invoice details, so I do not want to paste it into the general team chat." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. It means three users have reported this symptom. I need the agreed impact assessment before assigning a broader classification, but I can escalate now.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Ren says: "Someone suggested copying the visible rows manually. I am worried that might omit invoices across multiple pages, and we have not checked the totals." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Asha's response in turn 6. It connects Ren's preceding point with Ren's follow-up. A symptom is the observed failure; its extent and underlying cause still need assessment before classifying the whole incident.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Ren says: "Can I tell my manager the technical team will fix it before three? They are asking me for a firm answer about the billing run." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Ren says: "Please do. Would a screenshot help? It shows invoice details, so I do not want to paste it into the general team chat." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 8

E / Conversation

1. impact

Turn 2. Impact describes the work disrupted, here preparation of the billing file, rather than merely the technical error.

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. scope

Turn 4. Scope identifies the affected function and population; the current evidence points to export rather than complete application unavailability.

3. symptom

Turn 6. A symptom is the observed failure; its extent and underlying cause still need assessment before classifying the whole incident.

4. error message

Turn 8. The error message gives diagnostic wording; it should be recorded without unnecessarily widening access to invoice data.

5. workaround

Turn 10. A workaround reduces impact temporarily; an unverified manual copy may not produce the complete file needed for billing.

6. restoration time

Turn 12. Restoration time concerns when service works again; it is different from a support response or scheduled update.

7. escalation

Turn 14. Escalation brings the application specialists into the investigation; it does not itself establish a repair deadline.

8. duplicate ticket

Turn 16. A duplicate ticket may refer to the same underlying incident; linking it preserves evidence without treating it as a separate resolved fault.

9. assignment group

Turn 18. The assignment group identifies the team handling the next investigation step rather than the business user awaiting the result.

10. closure criterion

Turn 20. A closure criterion states the evidence needed before marking the incident resolved, here a working export with the required file checks.

Return to the conversation, page 10

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which question establishes business impact?

D. What work cannot proceed without that file?

The blocked task establishes business consequences. Error codes, comparison periods and ownership are useful triage details but answer different questions.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F2. What does "three reported users" avoid claiming?

D. That the affected population is limited to three

Reported counts identify known reports, not a verified upper limit on all affected users.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F / Guided speaking

1. failure

Analyst: The confirmed failure is printing to that device, not document editing.

Turn 1. The user can edit and save; only printing to the named device is confirmed to fail.

2. printer

User: I have not verified an alternative printer yet.

Turn 2. Another printer is untested, so it cannot be presented as a confirmed workaround.

3. restoration

Analyst: I will report the meeting deadline separately from the unknown restoration time.

Turn 3. The meeting's deadline does not establish when the printer service will be restored.

4. update

User: Please give me a timed update even if the repair is still pending.

Turn 4. A progress update is a controllable communication action and can accurately report an unfinished repair.

Return to the conversation, page 13

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from ""The system is down" means the export fails". Ren: "Noon for an update, not necessarily a fix. I'll make that clear to my manager. Please put it in the ticket too." Asha: [missing response] Ren: "My colleagues each opened a ticket. Should they close theirs now, or leave them open so the team can see that this is not just me?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I will. I am sending a technical escalation with the confirmed scope, the error details, and your business deadline as separate fields.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Ren says: "The finance system is down, and billing needs the monthly file by three. I have already tried twice, so this is becoming urgent for us." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Ren says: "That captures it. Please include me on the noon update. Once they say it is fixed, I can verify the export and compare the file totals." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Asha's response in turn 14. It connects Ren's preceding point with Ren's follow-up. Escalation brings the application specialists into the investigation; it does not itself establish a repair deadline.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Ren says: "Two colleagues have the same problem. We have not checked older periods or asked the other office. Does that mean it is a major outage?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 13

02 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which pattern is established?

D. Office access works; four VPN users report failure.

The reports establish an access-path difference, but no specific network mechanism has yet been tested.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A2. Which cause is confirmed?

A. None of the proposed causes

The briefing explicitly says the relevant checks have not been performed.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A3. What constraint applies to investigation?

C. Follow the approved process without changing production on a guess.

The case permits approved diagnosis, not speculative production changes or unsupported status claims.

Return to the exercise, page 14

D / Response choices

D1. Which statement preserves the evidence boundary?

C. The VPN path is associated with the reported failures; the cause is unconfirmed.

The observed path difference is real, but the specific cause still requires testing.

Return to the exercise, page 18

D2. Which question distinguishes the observed failure from a proposed cause?

D. Did the request time out, get refused, or show a certificate warning?

Asking for the actual observed outcome preserves symptoms. The alternatives assume mechanisms or causes that have not been tested.

Return to the exercise, page 18

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A numerical network address used by the Internet Protocol. Which term fits?

D. IP address

A Not here. certificate: A signed digital statement used to bind identity and a public key. The usual combination is "review a certificate warning".

B Not here. port: A numbered transport endpoint associated with a service. The usual combination is "identify the service port".

C Not here. routing: Selection of paths for network traffic. The usual combination is "review routing evidence".

D Correct. IP address: A numerical network address used by the Internet Protocol. The usual combination is "compare resolved IP addresses".

Return to the exercise, page 18

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis". Eli: "I can collect the wording and timestamps. Does the fact that their VPN says connected tell us that the connection to the portal is available?" Nia: [missing response] Eli: "Someone suggested changing the resolver for all VPN users and seeing whether the complaints stop. That would be a quick way to test the theory." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No. It confirms that connection state, not portal reachability. We need to follow the approved diagnostic process for the destination they actually need.

A Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 6. It connects Eli's preceding point with Eli's follow-up. Reachability concerns contacting the particular destination under the tested conditions; VPN connection status alone does not establish it.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Eli says: "If the lookup gives the same address on both paths, should we remove DNS from the report completely and say it is definitely the firewall?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Eli says: "We do not have that result yet. The reports all use the same portal address, and everyone says the page will not open after connecting." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Eli says: "Four VPN users cannot reach the staff portal, while the office test works. This must be DNS. I am ready to put that in the incident update." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 18

E / Conversation

1. hypothesis

Turn 2. A hypothesis is a proposed explanation; the path difference alone does not establish which network component caused it.

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. symptom

Turn 4. The symptom is the observed failure, such as a timeout or warning, not the user's general description that the page will not open.

3. reachability

Turn 6. Reachability concerns contacting the particular destination under the tested conditions; VPN connection status alone does not establish it.

4. name resolution

Turn 8. Name resolution maps the portal name to records; comparing results helps assess the DNS hypothesis without assuming it is correct.

5. hostname

Turn 10. The hostname identifies the specific named destination; a comparable investigation needs the same target rather than merely the same application description.

6. access policy

Turn 12. An access policy governs permission under specified conditions; it is another possible explanation that requires its own evidence.

7. timeout

Turn 14. A timeout means the waiting period expired; it differs from a completed but slow response or an explicit refusal.

8. time zone

Turn 16. The time zone makes timestamps comparable across logs and reports; a clock time alone can point investigators to the wrong events.

9. comparison

Turn 18. A comparison uses specified, comparable conditions; it can narrow explanations without turning an untested alternative into a finding.

10. diagnosis

Turn 20. A diagnosis is an evidence-based explanation; revising an early theory is part of reaching it rather than a failure of the investigation.

Return to the conversation, page 20

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What does a successful name lookup establish?

B. That this lookup returned a result under the tested conditions

Name resolution is one step and cannot certify later connectivity or authorization.

Return to the exercise, page 22

F2. Which commitment is appropriate before diagnosis?

A. I will report the comparison results and remaining hypotheses.

A result-based update is achievable without promising an unverified repair or bypassing controls.

Return to the exercise, page 22

F / Guided speaking

1. warning

Analyst: The reported symptom is a certificate warning, not a confirmed DNS failure.

Turn 1. The user reported a specific warning; the scenario contains no DNS finding.

2. timestamp

Engineer: Record the hostname and the timestamp with its time zone.

Turn 2. A timestamp with time zone helps authorized reviewers match the reported event to the appropriate records.

3. hypothesis

Analyst: The proxy path is another hypothesis to investigate.

Turn 3. The proxy has not been reviewed, so its involvement is a proposed explanation rather than a conclusion.

4. bypass

Engineer: Follow the approved process; do not ask the user to bypass the warning.

Turn 4. The case authorizes investigation, not circumventing a security warning or changing trust decisions.

Return to the conversation, page 23

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis". Eli: "I'll ask whether the page eventually opens or never loads. The reports just say slow, so I may have combined different problems." Nia: [missing response] Eli: "Who should collect the approved network checks? I can gather user reports, but I do not have permission to inspect every network device involved." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Record a timeout only if that is the actual result. Do not infer it from a user saying the request took too long.

A Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 14. It connects Eli's preceding point with Eli's follow-up. A timeout means the waiting period expired; it differs from a completed but slow response or an explicit refusal.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Eli says: "If the lookup gives the same address on both paths, should we remove DNS from the report completely and say it is definitely the firewall?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Eli says: "Four VPN users cannot reach the staff portal, while the office test works. This must be DNS. I am ready to put that in the incident update." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Eli says: "I can collect the wording and timestamps. Does the fact that their VPN says connected tell us that the connection to the portal is available?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 23

03 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What task does Jo need to perform?

C. Download a monthly report

The stated need is a report download, not general administrative control.

Return to the exercise, page 27

A2. Who approves the system role?

A. The system owner

The manager confirms business need, while the system owner has role-approval authority in this case.

Return to the exercise, page 27

A3. What remains unverified?

D. Whether the reporting role permits the download

The reporting role is a possible fit, not yet a verified authorization solution.

Return to the exercise, page 27

D / Response choices

D1. Which request is best scoped?

D. Access to download the named monthly report for the assignment period

The correct request states a resource, action, and duration without adding unrelated permissions.

Return to the exercise, page 31

D2. Which statement distinguishes authentication from authorization?

B. Signing in does not prove permission to download the report.

Identity verification and permission to perform a specific action are separate controls.

Return to the exercise, page 31

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An allowed action or access right. Which term fits?

B. permission

A Not here. business justification: The work-related reason supporting a request. The usual combination is "document the business justification".

B Correct. permission: An allowed action or access right. The usual combination is "grant a specific permission".

C Not here. MFA: Multifactor authentication; use of distinct factor types. The usual combination is "complete MFA verification".

D Not here. privileged access: Access allowing sensitive or powerful actions. The usual combination is "review privileged access".

Return to the exercise, page 31

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A report request does not justify administrator access". Jo: "I assumed signing in meant I already had access and the download error was just a technical fault. Are those separate parts of the process?" Imani: [missing response] Jo: "Could you assign the reporting role now and let me check whether it works? My manager needs the analysis, and I am only here temporarily." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Yes. Authentication gets you through the identity check. Authorization determines which resources and actions the account is allowed to use afterward.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Jo says: "Will the approval email mean I can download immediately, or is there another step after that?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Imani's response in turn 6. It connects Jo's preceding point with Jo's follow-up. Authentication establishes identity evidence; it does not automatically authorize every action within the application.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Jo says: "I need administrator access to finish the monthly reporting work. I can sign in, but the download gives me an access-denied message every time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Jo says: "It is the monthly sales summary. I only need to download it and analyze the file. I am not changing accounts or system settings." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 31

E / Conversation

1. permission

Turn 2. A permission authorizes a particular action; the required download does not itself justify broad administrative control.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. business justification

Turn 4. The business justification states the work-related need, here report analysis, rather than adopting the requested privilege level without examination.

3. Authentication

Turn 6. Authentication establishes identity evidence; it does not automatically authorize every action within the application.

4. entitlements

Turn 8. Entitlements are the specific granted rights attached to the role or account; a helpful role name does not prove the necessary download right.

5. approver

Turn 10. The approver is the person authorized to make this access decision; confirming a business need is not the same decision.

6. expiration

Turn 12. Expiration specifies when the entitlement should end, matching temporary access to the stated assignment rather than leaving it open indefinitely.

7. credentials

Turn 14. Credentials establish access to an identity; sharing them can obscure who acted and does not authorize the recipient's use.

8. least privilege

Turn 16. Least privilege limits access to the legitimate task; urgency affects handling speed, not the necessary breadth of permissions.

9. provisioning

Turn 18. Provisioning is the actual assignment of the approved access; an approval message does not prove that assignment has already occurred.

10. deprovisioning

Turn 20. Deprovisioning removes access no longer required; assigning its ownership makes the temporary-access end condition actionable.

Return to the conversation, page 33

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Who should confirm business need in this case?

D. Jo's manager

The case assigns business-need confirmation to Jo's manager; role approval remains the system owner's separate decision.

Return to the exercise, page 35

F2. Which status is accurate before approval?

B. Submitted for review; access has not been granted.

Submission starts review; it does not establish approval, provisioning, or permanent entitlement.

Return to the exercise, page 35

F / Guided speaking

1. viewing

Analyst: The requested action is viewing, not editing or administration.

Turn 1. The contractor's stated task is to view one dashboard; additional control is not justified by that task.

2. approval

Manager: I can confirm the business need, but the owner provides approval.

Turn 2. The case separates confirmation of need from the owner's authorization decision.

3. duration

Analyst: The request will include a two-week duration.

Turn 3. The access period should match the temporary task instead of becoming indefinite.

4. pending

Manager: Until review is complete, describe the access as pending.

Turn 4. No approval has been recorded, so granted or active would overstate the current status.

Return to the conversation, page 36

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A report request does not justify administrator access". Jo: "While we wait, a colleague offered to download the file using their account. Is that the same as sharing their password so I can do it myself?" Imani: [missing response] Jo: "I'll ask the report owner. In the meantime, can you flag the deadline and get the role review moving?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Those are different proposals, and neither should bypass the approved process. Do not share credentials. Ask the report owner whether an authorized delivery route is permitted.

A Correct. This is Imani's response in turn 14. It connects Jo's preceding point with Jo's follow-up. Credentials establish access to an identity; sharing them can obscure who acted and does not authorize the recipient's use.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Jo says: "Could you assign the reporting role now and let me check whether it works? My manager needs the analysis, and I am only here temporarily." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Jo says: "I need administrator access to finish the monthly reporting work. I can sign in, but the download gives me an access-denied message every time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Jo says: "My manager can confirm the work is required. Does that approval cover the role too, or does the system owner need a separate request?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 36

04 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which cost difference is confirmed?

B. Only Option B includes backup storage.

The briefing identifies backup inclusion as different and leaves transfer and support unconfirmed.

Return to the exercise, page 37

A2. What is the headline difference?

B. $250 per month

Subtracting $800 from $1,050 gives $250, but that is not a verified like-for-like saving.

Return to the exercise, page 37

A3. Which conclusion is premature?

C. Option A is the cheaper complete solution.

The complete scope and missing charges are unresolved, so the cheaper headline cannot establish the cheaper complete service.

Return to the exercise, page 37

D / Response choices

D1. Which comparison is defensible now?

A. A is $250 lower before its missing backup and other unconfirmed costs are resolved.

The correct statement gives the arithmetic while preserving the unequal scope and unknown items.

Return to the exercise, page 41

D2. How should an unconfirmed transfer charge appear?

D. Unknown, with the required assumption identified

Missing information must remain explicit; entering zero or included would invent a cost assumption.

Return to the exercise, page 41

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A software-defined computing environment emulating a machine. Which term fits?

D. virtual machine

A Not here. snapshot: A point-in-time representation of data or system state. The usual combination is "document a snapshot policy".

B Not here. egress: Data leaving a defined network or service boundary. The usual combination is "estimate egress charges".

C Not here. cost allocation: Assignment of expenses to services or owners. The usual combination is "document cost allocation".

D Correct. virtual machine: A software-defined computing environment emulating a machine. The usual combination is "provision a virtual machine".

Return to the exercise, page 41

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage". Jordan: "I will request the missing backup amount. Should I put zero against transfer charges until the provider confirms them, so the spreadsheet totals correctly?" Sal: [missing response] Jordan: "Understood. The workload estimate also assumes the current data volume. We expect growth, but the higher-use scenario has not been agreed with the application owner." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. No. Mark them unknown and record the assumed traffic. A working formula should not turn an unanswered pricing question into a free service.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Jordan says: "Understood. The workload estimate also assumes the current data volume. We expect growth, but the higher-use scenario has not been agreed with the application owner." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Jordan says: "Option A is $800 a month and Option B is $1,050. I was going to recommend A as a $250 monthly saving for the application." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Sal's response in turn 6. It connects Jordan's preceding point with Jordan's follow-up. Unknown preserves missing information; zero would falsely assert that the charge has been established as nothing.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Jordan says: "For backups, is matching the storage amount enough? B includes a line for retained copies, but I have not seen evidence of a restore test." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 41

E / Conversation

1. inclusions

Turn 2. Inclusions identify what the quoted amount covers; unequal included services make headline totals unsuitable as equivalent-service savings.

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. headline difference

Turn 4. The headline difference is the subtraction of the displayed estimates, not a verified saving after aligning their scope.

3. unknown

Turn 6. Unknown preserves missing information; zero would falsely assert that the charge has been established as nothing.

4. consumption

Turn 8. Consumption is actual or assumed resource use; estimates are meaningful only when the usage basis is explicit.

5. retention period

Turn 10. The retention period states how long copies are kept; it affects scope and cost but does not prove successful recovery.

6. RPO

Turn 12. Recovery point objective concerns the tolerated interval of data loss; it is distinct from the time needed to restore the service.

7. commitment

Turn 14. A commitment can impose term or spending conditions; the displayed monthly equivalent does not fully describe those obligations.

8. line item

Turn 16. A line item separates a cost or service component so its coverage and assumptions can be compared explicitly.

9. like-for-like

Turn 18. Like-for-like means comparing equivalent scope and assumptions, rather than selecting between superficially similar but different totals.

10. audit trail

Turn 20. An audit trail records the assumptions and decisions supporting the estimate, so later reviewers can understand why a recommendation was made.

Return to the conversation, page 43

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which question concerns RPO?

C. How far back may the recovered data point be relative to the disruption?

Recovery point objective concerns the tolerated data-loss interval. Restoration duration is RTO; retention duration and storage volume answer other planning questions.

Return to the exercise, page 45

F2. What does included backup storage fail to establish?

D. That a successful restore has been tested

Storing a backup and demonstrating recoverability are separate matters.

Return to the exercise, page 45

F / Guided speaking

1. scope

Analyst: The $2,000 difference compares unequal scope.

Turn 1. The two quotes differ in migration coverage, so their totals do not yet describe equivalent services.

2. exclusion

Manager: List migration as an exclusion from A, not an assumed free service.

Turn 2. Quote A explicitly leaves migration out; treating it as free would invent an inclusion.

3. unknown

Analyst: I will keep the additional amount marked unknown until it is confirmed.

Turn 3. No amount has been established, so unknown is more accurate than zero.

4. like-for-like

Manager: Then request a like-for-like comparison before recommending a purchase.

Turn 4. Aligning the migration scope and other assumptions makes the cost comparison decision-relevant.

Return to the conversation, page 46

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage". Jordan: "I will also check whether either price assumes a long commitment. A may be an on-demand estimate, while B may rely on an advance reservation." Sal: [missing response] Jordan: "What about support? The summary says support available, but it does not specify coverage hours or which incidents receive the quoted response level." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Exactly. Any commitment belongs beside the monthly figure. A lower unit rate can involve obligations that change the decision.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Jordan says: "Not yet. A's estimate explicitly excludes backup storage. I also have not confirmed transfer charges or support coverage for either option, so the comparison is incomplete." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Sal's response in turn 14. It connects Jordan's preceding point with Jordan's follow-up. A commitment can impose term or spending conditions; the displayed monthly equivalent does not fully describe those obligations.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Jordan says: "What about support? The summary says support available, but it does not specify coverage hours or which incidents receive the quoted response level." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Jordan says: "The application owner mentioned an RPO and an RTO. I want to make sure I ask the right question rather than using those labels interchangeably." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 46

05 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. How many laptops report successful installation?

B. 180

The console reports 180 successes; offline devices and installation errors are separate remaining groups.

Return to the exercise, page 49

A2. What is known about the remaining twenty?

B. Twelve were offline and eight returned errors.

The briefing gives two unresolved states and explicitly says no exception has been approved.

Return to the exercise, page 49

A3. Why is complete premature?

C. Not all devices are installed and verified under the stated criteria.

Installation remains unresolved for twenty devices, and verification is not complete for all reported successes.

Return to the exercise, page 49

D / Response choices

D1. Which status statement is accurate?

A. 180 installed; twelve offline; eight errors; verification still in progress.

The correct statement preserves each known state without inventing completion, exceptions, or verification failures.

Return to the exercise, page 53

D2. What percentage reports successful installation?

D. 90 percent

Dividing 180 successful reports by 200 in-scope devices gives 90 percent.

Return to the exercise, page 53

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A software update intended to correct or change behavior. Which term fits?

A. patch

A Correct. patch: A software update intended to correct or change behavior. The usual combination is "deploy an approved patch".

B Not here. configuration baseline: The agreed reference configuration. The usual combination is "compare with the configuration baseline".

C Not here. reboot: Restarting a system. The usual combination is "identify a pending reboot".

D Not here. supersedence: Replacement of an earlier update by another. The usual combination is "check patch supersedence".

Return to the exercise, page 53

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Ninety percent installed is not complete". Casey: "What should we call the twelve offline laptops? They may simply belong to people who were away. I do not want to count them as failed installations." Arun: [missing response] Casey: "Someone suggested excluding the offline devices from the total for now. That would make the progress figure look closer to the target while we contact their owners." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep them in an offline group. They remain in scope, but their status differs from the eight devices that actually returned installation errors.

A Correct. This is Arun's response in turn 6. It connects Casey's preceding point with Casey's follow-up. Offline identifies devices unavailable to the management system; it does not assert that an installation was attempted and failed.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Casey says: "The manager wants to know whether the laptop deployment is complete. The console shows 180 successes out of 200. Can I mark the rollout done?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Casey says: "I will ask for owners and next actions for both groups. What about the successful devices that still need a restart before their new state takes effect?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Casey says: "Understood. For the eight errors, do we have enough information to promise a successful retry today, or do we need a separate technical review first?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 53

E / Conversation

1. installation

Turn 2. Installation is the software's reported setup state; it is not automatically the complete verified deployment state.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. completion criterion

Turn 4. The completion criterion defines the evidence required for done; an installation percentage does not replace the required verification.

3. offline

Turn 6. Offline identifies devices unavailable to the management system; it does not assert that an installation was attempted and failed.

4. denominator

Turn 8. The denominator is the total in-scope count; changing it without approval would make the percentage misleading.

5. error codes

Turn 10. Error codes identify reported conditions that may require different responses; the count alone cannot establish that a retry will succeed.

6. reboot

Turn 12. A reboot is a restart; if required for the approved state, installation alone is not enough to claim verification.

7. exception

Turn 14. An exception is an approved departure with conditions, not a label the team applies simply because a device remains unresolved.

8. inventory

Turn 16. The inventory identifies the in-scope devices and their attributes; a verification-pending subset must not be added to the installed group as if it contained additional devices.

9. remediation

Turn 18. Remediation is the work assigned to correct outstanding deficiencies; naming it does not claim that those deficiencies are already corrected.

10. criteria

Turn 20. Criteria are the conditions defining acceptable completion; clear reporting follows those conditions rather than an attractive percentage.

Return to the conversation, page 55

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which action would distort the report?

C. Removing offline devices from scope without an approved change

Unapproved removal changes the denominator to improve appearance rather than reflect the agreed scope.

Return to the exercise, page 57

F2. Which statement describes a plan rather than a result?

B. A retry is scheduled for the eight errors.

Scheduled identifies intended future work; it does not establish the retry outcome.

Return to the exercise, page 57

F / Guided speaking

1. reboot

Engineer: Installation is reported successful, but a reboot is still pending.

Turn 1. The required restart has not occurred, so the installation status cannot imply the final operational state.

2. verification

Owner: Then the service check is still part of verification.

Turn 2. Verification checks that the required state and service behavior have actually been achieved.

3. complete

Engineer: I will describe the update as in progress, not complete.

Turn 3. The required restart and service check remain unfinished, so complete would overstate the evidence.

4. criteria

Owner: Keep the approved recovery route available until the criteria are met.

Turn 4. The completion conditions, not the installation message alone, determine when the work can be closed.

Return to the conversation, page 58

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Ninety percent installed is not complete". Casey: "If a laptop cannot be updated during this window because of a documented application dependency, can the team mark it as an exception in the report?" Arun: [missing response] Casey: "I'll show those states separately. But can a device be both installed and pending verification? I don't want the totals to exceed two hundred." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Only after the authorized exception decision. Record the reason, owner, and review condition; do not convert an unresolved error into an approved departure automatically.

A Correct. This is Arun's response in turn 14. It connects Casey's preceding point with Casey's follow-up. An exception is an approved departure with conditions, not a label the team applies simply because a device remains unresolved.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Casey says: "The manager wants to know whether the laptop deployment is complete. The console shows 180 successes out of 200. Can I mark the rollout done?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Casey says: "Understood. For the eight errors, do we have enough information to promise a successful retry today, or do we need a separate technical review first?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Casey says: "I will ask for owners and next actions for both groups. What about the successful devices that still need a restart before their new state takes effect?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 58

06 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is confirmed?

A. An unusual-sign-in alert occurred at 09:12 UTC.

The alert and its timestamp are known; legitimacy, compromise, and data impact remain unconfirmed.

Return to the exercise, page 59

A2. Who decides containment under this case's process?

B. Authorized responders

The briefing assigns containment decisions to authorized responders, not to every person seeing the alert.

Return to the exercise, page 59

A3. Where should detailed evidence be placed?

C. The approved restricted evidence channel

Use the designated evidence route. An unconfirmed classification, a personal copy or partial redaction does not make another destination approved.

Return to the exercise, page 59

D / Response choices

D1. Which initial report is accurate?

D. Unusual-sign-in alert at 09:12 UTC; owner confirmation and scope review pending.

The accurate report supplies the known event and missing checks without prematurely confirming or dismissing the issue.

Return to the exercise, page 63

D2. What does "owner confirmation pending" establish?

B. Confirmation has not been completed.

Pending identifies an unfinished check and does not supply either possible outcome.

Return to the exercise, page 63

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Unauthorized access or loss of a system's trusted state. Which term fits?

B. compromise

A Not here. severity: The assessed seriousness of an incident or finding. The usual combination is "review incident severity".

B Correct. compromise: Unauthorized access or loss of a system's trusted state. The usual combination is "investigate suspected compromise".

C Not here. geolocation: An estimate of geographical position from available signals. The usual combination is "qualify a geolocation estimate".

D Not here. eradication: Removal of identified causes or malicious elements under a response process. The usual combination is "distinguish eradication from containment".

Return to the exercise, page 63

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise". Bea: "The alert includes a location estimate that differs from the user's usual pattern. I have not checked whether travel or another legitimate explanation could account for it." Tomas: [missing response] Bea: "I also have not reviewed subsequent data access. I will leave impact unknown rather than saying no data was accessed just because that field is empty." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep that geolocation limitation explicit. Do not report physical travel as fact, and do not dismiss the event merely because a benign explanation is possible.

A Correct. This is Tomas's response in turn 6. It connects Bea's preceding point with Bea's follow-up. Geolocation is an estimate based on available signals; it is not verified evidence of the person's physical location.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Bea says: "Should the subject say confirmed compromise so the on-call responder treats it urgently? I do not want a qualified title to make this seem unimportant." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Bea says: "I'll submit it now. If the on-call responder hasn't accepted it, I'll follow the escalation route rather than leave it in the queue." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Bea says: "Understood. The business lead is already asking whether we must notify customers. I do not have enough information to answer that, and no data review is complete." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 63

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. restricted channel

Turn 2. The restricted channel keeps detailed account evidence available to authorized responders without broadly distributing it.

2. alert

Turn 4. An alert is a signal requiring assessment; it does not alone establish unauthorized access or compromise.

3. geolocation

Turn 6. Geolocation is an estimate based on available signals; it is not verified evidence of the person's physical location.

4. scope assessment

Turn 8. A scope assessment determines what accounts, assets, or data are affected; an unreviewed area cannot be declared unaffected.

5. containment

Turn 10. Containment limits possible consequences and is an operational decision for the role authorized in this case.

6. timeline

Turn 12. A timeline orders events using comparable timestamps; inconsistent time zones can lead reviewers to associate the wrong records.

7. classification

Turn 14. Classification records the assessed type or status of the event; one new statement should be handled through the approved review rather than automatic closure.

8. notification

Turn 16. Notification decisions concern designated recipients and applicable obligations; they have authorized owners separate from the initial alert reporter.

9. need-to-know

Turn 18. Need-to-know limits detailed information to people who require it for their role, while allowing a suitable broader status summary.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. under review

Turn 20. Under review accurately marks an unresolved assessment; it neither clears the alert nor confirms a breach before the evidence supports either result.

Return to the conversation, page 65

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which question clarifies response ownership?

D. Who has accepted responsibility for the containment decision under the approved process?

The question asks for an accepted, authorized decision responsibility. Seeing an alert, sending an update or possessing access does not establish that ownership.

Return to the exercise, page 68

F2. Which statement overclaims scope?

C. Every account is affected because one alert fired.

A single account alert cannot establish that every account is affected without further investigation.

Return to the exercise, page 68

F / Guided speaking

1. confirmed

Analyst: The email is reported suspicious; malicious content is not yet confirmed.

Turn 1. A report identifies a concern, but analysis has not established what the attachment contains.

2. route

Coordinator: Use the approved reporting route for the original message.

Turn 2. The defined route sends the evidence to authorized reviewers instead of encouraging informal redistribution.

3. unknown

Analyst: Whether anyone interacted with it remains unknown.

Turn 3. No interaction has been confirmed, which is not evidence that interaction either did or did not occur.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

4. know

Coordinator: Keep the wider update limited to the audience's need to know.

Turn 4. The need-to-know principle restricts unnecessary distribution of potentially sensitive incident information.

Return to the conversation, page 69

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise". Bea: "If the owner later says the activity was theirs, can I close the alert immediately, or does the response team need to review that confirmation first?" Tomas: [missing response] Bea: "Understood. The business lead is already asking whether we must notify customers. I do not have enough information to answer that, and no data review is complete." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Follow the assigned review route. Confirmation is evidence, but the authorized reviewer decides the classification using the whole record and the organization's criteria.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Bea says: "Should the subject say confirmed compromise so the on-call responder treats it urgently? I do not want a qualified title to make this seem unimportant." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Tomas's response in turn 14. It connects Bea's preceding point with Bea's follow-up. Classification records the assessed type or status of the event; one new statement should be handled through the approved review rather than automatic closure.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Bea says: "I also have not reviewed subsequent data access. I will leave impact unknown rather than saying no data was accessed just because that field is empty." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Bea says: "The alert includes a location estimate that differs from the user's usual pattern. I have not checked whether travel or another legitimate explanation could account for it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 69

07 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which window is approved?

B. Thursday, 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time

The approved change record specifies Thursday evening in local branch time.

Return to the exercise, page 73

A2. What actually changed?

D. The notice contained an error; the approved window did not change.

The case distinguishes a mistaken communication from a change to the authorized schedule.

Return to the exercise, page 73

A3. Which consequence is known?

D. One team moved its export schedule.

The briefing identifies one concrete downstream scheduling consequence without establishing wider damage.

Return to the exercise, page 73

D / Response choices

D1. Which subject line matches the facts?

D. Correction: Thursday maintenance window; Tuesday date was incorrect

The correct response corrects the message without inventing a change to the approved schedule or completed work.

Return to the exercise, page 77

D2. Which sentence identifies the controlling communication?

B. This correction supersedes the earlier notice.

Supersedes explicitly replaces the inaccurate notice and reduces competing interpretations.

Return to the exercise, page 77

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A communication of planned service work and impact. Which term fits?

A. maintenance notice

A Correct. maintenance notice: A communication of planned service work and impact. The usual combination is "correct a maintenance notice".

B Not here. implementation plan: The defined plan for carrying out a change. The usual combination is "confirm the implementation plan".

C Not here. source of truth: The agreed authoritative record for a particular fact. The usual combination is "name the source of truth".

D Not here. known error: A recognized problem with documented diagnostic context or handling. The usual combination is "document a known error".

Return to the exercise, page 77

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct the maintenance date before users act on it". Mina: "Should I title the message maintenance moved to Thursday? That sounds concise, but it could imply Tuesday was once the authorized schedule, which it was not." Owen: [missing response] Mina: "I will include Thursday, eight to nine p.m., local branch time. I also need to say that the new message replaces the earlier notice in case both circulate." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Exactly. Say the Tuesday date was incorrect and state the approved maintenance window. The authorization did not change; our message failed to match it.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Mina says: "I found an error in yesterday's maintenance notice. I wrote Tuesday from eight to nine, but the approved record says Thursday during that same hour." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Mina says: "I'll send it now and call the export team next. I'll let you know this afternoon if anyone still has a conflict with Thursday." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Owen's response in turn 6. It connects Mina's preceding point with Mina's follow-up. The maintenance window is the authorized work period, which remains Thursday from eight to nine in this case.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Mina says: "After the urgent correction, we should review how the wrong date entered the notice. I copied an earlier planning note instead of checking the approved record." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 77

E / Conversation

1. correction

Turn 2. A correction replaces inaccurate information; another unexplained message could leave both dates appearing valid.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. impact

Turn 4. Impact includes the team's changed work schedule; the absence of an outage does not mean the mistaken notice had no consequences.

3. maintenance window

Turn 6. The maintenance window is the authorized work period, which remains Thursday from eight to nine in this case.

4. supersedes

Turn 8. Supersedes states that the corrected communication replaces the earlier one as the version recipients should use.

5. recipient list

Turn 10. The recipient list identifies the message audience; known forwarding may require further communication beyond the original addressees.

6. dependency

Turn 12. A dependency is scheduled work affected by another condition; the export plan may now depend on confirmation of the maintenance timing.

7. source of truth

Turn 14. The source of truth is the agreed authoritative record; the communication correction does not itself alter or renew the underlying approval.

8. Acknowledgment

Turn 16. Acknowledgment confirms receipt or understanding, not permission to carry out the change or proof that every resulting action is finished.

9. action owner

Turn 18. An action owner is accountable for completing the agreed improvement, making follow-up more specific than a general request to be careful.

10. audit trail

Turn 20. The audit trail preserves what was sent, corrected, and confirmed, allowing later review without hiding the original communication error.

Return to the conversation, page 79

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What does receipt acknowledgment establish?

A. That the recipient received or understood the correction

Receipt or understanding is narrower than approval or completion of downstream actions.

Return to the exercise, page 81

F2. Which follow-up is concrete and accountable?

B. Name an owner to verify future notices against the approved record.

A named verification action can be performed and checked; vague intentions and deleted history do not create that control.

Return to the exercise, page 81

F / Guided speaking

1. incorrect

Communicator: The 4.2 reference was incorrect; the approved version is 4.1.

Turn 1. The error is in the notice; the approved version remains 4.1.

2. supersedes

Coordinator: State that the correction supersedes the earlier notice.

Turn 2. Supersedes tells readers which communication replaces the inaccurate version.

3. truth

Communicator: The approved record remains the source of truth.

Turn 3. The controlled record, not either informal assumption, governs the authorized version.

4. approval

Coordinator: Ask recipients to acknowledge the correction, not to provide new approval.

Turn 4. Receipt of a corrected notice is distinct from authorizing a different deployment.

Return to the conversation, page 82

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Correct the maintenance date before users act on it". Mina: "Do we need fresh change approval because I am issuing a corrected notice, or does the existing approved record remain valid for Thursday's work?" Owen: [missing response] Mina: "I'll call the export team as well. I need to know they've seen the correct time and whether it creates another scheduling problem." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The approved record remains the source of truth for this case. We are correcting its communication, not requesting a different window or scope.

A Correct. This is Owen's response in turn 14. It connects Mina's preceding point with Mina's follow-up. The source of truth is the agreed authoritative record; the communication correction does not itself alter or renew the underlying approval.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Mina says: "The maintenance has not begun. One team moved its invoice export because of my notice, so there is already a scheduling consequence even without a service interruption." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Mina says: "I will include Thursday, eight to nine p.m., local branch time. I also need to say that the new message replaces the earlier notice in case both circulate." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Mina says: "I found an error in yesterday's maintenance notice. I wrote Tuesday from eight to nine, but the approved record says Thursday during that same hour." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 82

08 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which metric has been reviewed?

D. Server CPU usage

The briefing confirms only the CPU panel; the other evidence has not been reviewed.

Return to the exercise, page 84

A2. What do the five reports establish?

D. Five users experienced slow checkout in the reported period.

The reports establish a user-visible symptom, not a cause or the total affected population.

Return to the exercise, page 84

A3. What is authorized now?

B. Review approved telemetry and coordinate investigation ownership

The case authorizes evidence review and coordination, not unapproved changes or unsupported resolution.

Return to the exercise, page 84

D / Response choices

D1. Which statement combines the evidence accurately?

B. CPU is normal on the observed panel; checkout slowness still requires investigation.

A normal resource measure can coexist with slow transactions; the cause remains unconfirmed.

Return to the exercise, page 88

D2. Which question resolves the meaning of service in this discussion?

B. By service, do you mean checkout or the Kubernetes Service resource?

Asking which meaning of service is intended separates the user-facing function from a named platform resource. The other questions concern freshness, ownership and time alignment.

Return to the exercise, page 88

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A group of machines or resources managed together. Which term fits?

D. cluster

A Not here. resource limit: A configured ceiling governing resource use. The usual combination is "inspect resource limits".

B Not here. span: A timed operation within a distributed trace. The usual combination is "identify a slow span".

C Not here. service: In Kubernetes, an abstraction exposing a group of endpoints. The usual combination is "inspect the service endpoints".

D Correct. cluster: A group of machines or resources managed together. The usual combination is "review cluster-level signals".

Return to the exercise, page 88

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy". Pat: "When you say the service is ready, do you mean checkout has been tested or that the Kubernetes readiness checks are passing for its pods?" Suri: [missing response] Pat: "Thanks for separating that. I can review the application trace for a reported transaction if we can match it to a request identifier and time." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I mean the configured readiness checks pass. That is useful evidence about those checks, not proof that every checkout completes promptly.

A Correct. This is Suri's response in turn 6. It connects Pat's preceding point with Pat's follow-up. Readiness reports whether an instance meets its configured traffic-acceptance check; it is not a complete test of every checkout behavior.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Pat says: "Thanks for separating that. I can review the application trace for a reported transaction if we can match it to a request identifier and time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Pat says: "I agree. I have not reviewed the request durations yet. The reports say checkout feels slow, but they do not identify whether payment or order confirmation is taking longer." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Pat says: "Then I'll start with the slowest recorded operation. If the trace has a gap, I'll flag it rather than guess what happened there." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 88

E / Conversation

1. metric

Turn 2. A metric measures a specified property; normal CPU does not establish the performance of the complete checkout transaction.

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. user journey

Turn 4. The user journey names the sequence producing the customer's outcome; a symptom should be located within that sequence.

3. readiness

Turn 6. Readiness reports whether an instance meets its configured traffic-acceptance check; it is not a complete test of every checkout behavior.

4. trace

Turn 8. A trace connects recorded operations across components for a request, helping locate where time is spent.

5. database wait

Turn 10. Database wait is time awaiting database work or resources; it is a plausible source of delay, not yet a finding here.

6. span

Turn 12. A span records a timed operation within the trace; it can show a contribution to delay without proving every unrecorded cause.

7. change

Turn 14. A production change requires the approved decision route; success on a previous unrelated issue does not authorize or establish this remedy.

8. saturation

Turn 16. Saturation concerns pressure on constrained capacity; waiting and resource signals complement request traces without assuming a normal CPU panel covers every resource.

9. handoff

Turn 18. A handoff combines the evidence and next responsibility so separate observations are not mistaken for conflicting conclusions.

10. observability

Turn 20. Observability is the ability to understand system behavior from its signals; useful interpretation connects those signals to user-visible outcomes.

Return to the conversation, page 90

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What could a distributed trace help identify?

B. Which recorded operation contributes to the request delay

A trace records operations and timing for the traced request. Sampling limits and investigation are still needed before wider scope or causal conclusions.

Return to the exercise, page 93

F2. Which next step fits the stated authority?

A. Review approved telemetry and coordinate findings before proposing a production change.

The case permits investigation and coordination, while changes and outcome promises need further evidence and approval.

Return to the exercise, page 93

F / Guided speaking

1. check

Engineer: The readiness check passes for the lightweight endpoint.

Turn 1. The passing result belongs to the configured endpoint check, not the full search transaction.

2. journey

Reviewer: That does not establish the complete search journey is healthy.

Turn 2. The complete user journey includes work beyond the lightweight readiness endpoint.

3. trace

Engineer: I will inspect the request trace to locate the recorded delay.

Turn 3. A request trace can connect operations and timings along the path of the failing search.

4. hypothesis

Reviewer: Keep the backend explanation as a hypothesis until the evidence supports it.

Turn 4. The backend has not been reviewed, so its involvement remains a proposed explanation.

Return to the conversation, page 94

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy". Pat: "Should we restart the pods while the investigation continues? A colleague suggested it because that helped with a different issue last month, but this cause is unknown." Suri: [missing response] Pat: "I'll take the request path. What can your team check at the same time? I'd rather split the work than have us both checking everything." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. A restart would be a production change. It needs the approved route and a reasoned proposal. We should not turn the previous incident's remedy into this incident's diagnosis.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Pat says: "Then the issue stays open. We have five reports, not a verified total of affected users, and no confirmed cause or approved remedy at this point." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Pat says: "I'll take the request path. What can your team check at the same time? I'd rather split the work than have us both checking everything." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Pat says: "Five users reported slow checkout in the last half hour. The platform dashboard shows normal CPU, so one colleague says the service must be healthy." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Suri's response in turn 14. It connects Pat's preceding point with Pat's follow-up. A production change requires the approved decision route; success on a previous unrelated issue does not authorize or establish this remedy.

Return to the exercise, page 94

Review 1 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Initial assessment of impact, priority, and ownership. Which term fits?

D. triage

A Not here. priority: The relative order or importance assigned to work. The usual combination is "assign a ticket priority".

B Not here. service owner: The role accountable for the service. The usual combination is "notify the service owner".

C Not here. workaround: A temporary way to reduce impact without fixing the cause. The usual combination is "verify a workaround".

D Correct. triage: Initial assessment of impact, priority, and ownership. The usual combination is "triage an incident".

Return to the exercise, page 25

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Time to live; a lifetime limit, with meaning depending on context. Which term fits?

C. TTL

A Not here. firewall: A control that permits or blocks network traffic under rules. The usual combination is "review firewall logs".

B Not here. VPN: Virtual private network; a connection providing a defined private access path. The usual combination is "connect through the VPN".

C Correct. TTL: Time to live; a lifetime limit, with meaning depending on context. The usual combination is "check a DNS record's TTL".

D Not here. connection refusal: An explicit rejection of a connection attempt. The usual combination is "distinguish refusal from timeout".

Return to the exercise, page 25

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from ""The system is down" means the export fails". Ren: "Someone suggested copying the visible rows manually. I am worried that might omit invoices across multiple pages, and we have not checked the totals." Asha: [missing response] Ren: "Can I tell my manager the technical team will fix it before three? They are asking me for a firm answer about the billing run." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Then it is an unverified workaround, not a solution I can recommend as complete. I will ask the service owner to assess an acceptable alternative.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Ren says: "Can I tell my manager the technical team will fix it before three? They are asking me for a firm answer about the billing run." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Ren says: "Two colleagues have the same problem. We have not checked older periods or asked the other office. Does that mean it is a major outage?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Asha's response in turn 10. It connects Ren's preceding point with Ren's follow-up. A workaround reduces impact temporarily; an unverified manual copy may not produce the complete file needed for billing.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Ren says: "Please do. Would a screenshot help? It shows invoice details, so I do not want to paste it into the general team chat." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 25

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis". Eli: "I will revise the update: four reports through the VPN, one successful office test, exact errors being collected, and no verified root cause yet." Nia: [missing response] Eli: "I'll remove the definite DNS diagnosis from the update now. Send me the comparison when it's ready and I'll add what it shows." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Good. The comparison should show what differs and what remains unchanged. That gives the next team something concrete to investigate.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Eli says: "Understood. I will ask whether all four people use the same VPN profile. If they do, that may help us narrow where to compare the configuration." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Eli says: "Four VPN users cannot reach the staff portal, while the office test works. This must be DNS. I am ready to put that in the incident update." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Eli says: "We do not have that result yet. The reports all use the same portal address, and everyone says the page will not open after connecting." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 18. It connects Eli's preceding point with Eli's follow-up. A comparison uses specified, comparable conditions; it can narrow explanations without turning an untested alternative into a finding.

Return to the exercise, page 25

Review 2 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Permission to perform an action on a resource. Which term fits?

B. authorization

A Not here. SSO: Single sign-on; using one authentication session across services. The usual combination is "troubleshoot an SSO session".

B Correct. authorization: Permission to perform an action on a resource. The usual combination is "check authorization".

C Not here. administrator: A role with broad system-management permissions. The usual combination is "justify administrator access".

D Not here. access request: A recorded request for specified permissions. The usual combination is "submit a scoped access request".

Return to the exercise, page 47

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Storage presented as addressable blocks. Which term fits?

A. block storage

A Correct. block storage: Storage presented as addressable blocks. The usual combination is "size block-storage volumes".

B Not here. on-demand: Resource use without the particular advance commitment being discussed. The usual combination is "estimate on-demand usage".

C Not here. cloud service: Computing capability delivered through a service model. The usual combination is "compare cloud services".

D Not here. RPO: Recovery point objective; tolerated data-loss interval. The usual combination is "agree on the RPO".

Return to the exercise, page 47

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis". Eli: "Understood. I will ask whether all four people use the same VPN profile. If they do, that may help us narrow where to compare the configuration." Nia: [missing response] Eli: "If the lookup gives the same address on both paths, should we remove DNS from the report completely and say it is definitely the firewall?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Yes, and include the source network and hostname. We want comparable requests, not a working office test against a different address.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Eli says: "Four VPN users cannot reach the staff portal, while the office test works. This must be DNS. I am ready to put that in the incident update." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Eli says: "I will revise the update: four reports through the VPN, one successful office test, exact errors being collected, and no verified root cause yet." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Eli says: "We do not have that result yet. The reports all use the same portal address, and everyone says the page will not open after connecting." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 10. It connects Eli's preceding point with Eli's follow-up. The hostname identifies the specific named destination; a comparable investigation needs the same target rather than merely the same application description.

Return to the exercise, page 47

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage". Jordan: "I'll hold the recommendation. For today's note, I'll show the two prices and the missing items, with provisional above the totals." Sal: [missing response] Jordan: "I'll put the inclusions and unresolved amounts in one table. Can we review it again when the provider answers the backup and support questions?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Yes. We are aiming for like-for-like totals and clearly stated differences. We do not need to pretend the two options are identical if meaningful differences remain.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Jordan says: "Option A is $800 a month and Option B is $1,050. I was going to recommend A as a $250 monthly saving for the application." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Jordan says: "I'll put the inclusions and unresolved amounts in one table. Can we review it again when the provider answers the backup and support questions?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Jordan says: "Understood. The workload estimate also assumes the current data volume. We expect growth, but the higher-use scenario has not been agreed with the application owner." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Sal's response in turn 18. It connects Jordan's preceding point with Jordan's follow-up. Like-for-like means comparing equivalent scope and assumptions, rather than selecting between superficially similar but different totals.

Return to the exercise, page 47

Review 3 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A record of devices and their relevant attributes. Which term fits?

A. asset inventory

A Correct. asset inventory: A record of devices and their relevant attributes. The usual combination is "reconcile the asset inventory".

B Not here. verification: Checking evidence that the required state has been achieved. The usual combination is "complete post-installation verification".

C Not here. pilot group: A limited group used to test a change before expansion. The usual combination is "validate the pilot group".

D Not here. compliance state: A device's status against defined requirements. The usual combination is "report the compliance state".

Return to the exercise, page 71

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A period or context of authenticated interaction. Which term fits?

D. session

A Not here. timeline: An ordered account of events with times. The usual combination is "build an incident timeline".

B Not here. escalation threshold: A condition requiring referral or higher attention. The usual combination is "apply the escalation threshold".

C Not here. alert: A signal that a condition may require attention. The usual combination is "triage an alert".

D Correct. session: A period or context of authenticated interaction. The usual combination is "review the account session".

Return to the exercise, page 71

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage". Jordan: "For backups, is matching the storage amount enough? B includes a line for retained copies, but I have not seen evidence of a restore test." Sal: [missing response] Jordan: "The application owner mentioned an RPO and an RTO. I want to make sure I ask the right question rather than using those labels interchangeably." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Storage and recoverability are different. Ask about the agreed retention period, recovery requirements, and the process for checking restoration under the approved plan.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Jordan says: "Understood. The workload estimate also assumes the current data volume. We expect growth, but the higher-use scenario has not been agreed with the application owner." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Jordan says: "Option A is $800 a month and Option B is $1,050. I was going to recommend A as a $250 monthly saving for the application." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Jordan says: "I will request the missing backup amount. Should I put zero against transfer charges until the provider confirms them, so the spreadsheet totals correctly?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Sal's response in turn 10. It connects Jordan's preceding point with Jordan's follow-up. The retention period states how long copies are kept; it affects scope and cost but does not prove successful recovery.

Return to the exercise, page 71

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise". Bea: "I'll send the business lead a short status update: who has the case, which checks are running, and what we still don't know. No account details." Tomas: [missing response] Bea: "I'll submit it now. If the on-call responder hasn't accepted it, I'll follow the escalation route rather than leave it in the queue." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Use a need-to-know summary for the audience. Clear communication does not mean every recipient receives every piece of evidence.

A Correct. This is Tomas's response in turn 18. It connects Bea's preceding point with Bea's follow-up. Need-to-know limits detailed information to people who require it for their role, while allowing a suitable broader status summary.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Bea says: "I will preserve the original record and use a redacted summary for the wider operational update. The timestamp will remain 09:12 UTC in both places." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Bea says: "Should the subject say confirmed compromise so the on-call responder treats it urgently? I do not want a qualified title to make this seem unimportant." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Bea says: "I also have not reviewed subsequent data access. I will leave impact unknown rather than saying no data was accessed just because that field is empty." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 71

Review 4 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Permission to carry out a specified change. Which term fits?

A. change approval

A Correct. change approval: Permission to carry out a specified change. The usual combination is "verify change approval".

B Not here. supersede: Replace an earlier record or statement as controlling. The usual combination is "supersede the earlier notice".

C Not here. problem record: A record tracking an underlying cause or recurring issue. The usual combination is "open a problem record".

D Not here. rollback plan: An approved route for returning to an earlier state. The usual combination is "review the rollback plan".

Return to the exercise, page 96

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A Kubernetes resource managing a desired set of replicated pods. Which term fits?

D. deployment

A Not here. replica: A copy of an application instance maintained for a workload. The usual combination is "compare replica behavior".

B Not here. platform: Shared technical services supporting applications. The usual combination is "coordinate with the platform team".

C Not here. log: A recorded event or message from a system. The usual combination is "review application logs".

D Correct. deployment: A Kubernetes resource managing a desired set of replicated pods. The usual combination is "review the deployment status".

Return to the exercise, page 96

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise". Bea: "Who decides whether any containment action is needed? I can preserve the alert, but I am not authorized to make changes to the account in this process." Tomas: [missing response] Bea: "I will preserve the original record and use a redacted summary for the wider operational update. The timestamp will remain 09:12 UTC in both places." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. The authorized response team owns containment. I will confirm the named responder has accepted the handoff rather than assume that receiving a message means someone is acting.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Bea says: "The alert includes a location estimate that differs from the user's usual pattern. I have not checked whether travel or another legitimate explanation could account for it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Bea says: "An unusual-sign-in alert fired for a staff account at 09:12 UTC. I have the event record, but the account owner has not confirmed the activity yet." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Tomas's response in turn 10. It connects Bea's preceding point with Bea's follow-up. Containment limits possible consequences and is an operational decision for the role authorized in this case.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Bea says: "I'll submit it now. If the on-call responder hasn't accepted it, I'll follow the escalation route rather than leave it in the queue." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 96

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy". Pat: "Who will combine the findings for the next update? Separate team messages might sound contradictory if one says resources are normal and another says customers are waiting." Suri: [missing response] Pat: "Then the issue stays open. We have five reports, not a verified total of affected users, and no confirmed cause or approved remedy at this point." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will coordinate the handoff. We can report both observations, explain their scope, and identify the next owner without declaring either team at fault.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Pat says: "Five users reported slow checkout in the last half hour. The platform dashboard shows normal CPU, so one colleague says the service must be healthy." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Suri's response in turn 18. It connects Pat's preceding point with Pat's follow-up. A handoff combines the evidence and next responsibility so separate observations are not mistaken for conflicting conclusions.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Pat says: "Then I'll start with the slowest recorded operation. If the trace has a gap, I'll flag it rather than guess what happened there." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Pat says: "Thanks for separating that. I can review the application trace for a reported transaction if we can match it to a request identifier and time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 96

Additional case 1 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. elapsed time

Turn 2. Elapsed time is the interval actually taken, here from 10 a.m. to 1:20 p.m.

2. recovery point

Turn 6. Recovery point identifies the time represented by recovered data, not when restoration finished.

3. restore duration

Turn 12. Restore duration is the time spent recovering data, one part of the overall recovery time.

4. test record

Turn 16. Test record preserves the conditions, observations, and results of the recovery exercise.

5. dependencies

Turn 18. Dependencies are prerequisites or other work that the proposed corrective actions rely on.

6. acceptance criteria

Turn 20. Acceptance criteria specify the conditions the next exercise must meet before it can pass.

Return to the conversation, page 99

Transfer exchange

1. verified

Manager: Can I describe two-hour recovery as verified?

Turn 1. Verified means supported by completed checks, which this claim currently lacks.

Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

2. recovery

Administrator: Not yet. We have backup-job results, not a timed recovery test.

Turn 2. Recovery tests whether the service and data can be restored as required.

3. objective

Manager: I'll label two hours as the agreed objective instead.

Turn 3. Objective describes a required target rather than an already measured result.

4. performance

Administrator: Good. The exercise will provide the missing performance evidence.

Turn 4. Performance evidence shows what the recovery process actually achieved under test conditions.

Return to the conversation, page 101

Additional case 2 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. cutoff

Turn 2. Cutoff is the specified time after which the departing employee's access must end.

2. service account

Turn 6. Service account means an identity for an automated process rather than a departing employee's personal identity.

3. retention policy

Turn 10. Retention policy determines how records are kept and disposed of; departure alone does not authorize deletion.

4. validation

Turn 14. Validation checks that the transferred workflow meets its intended requirements under the new ownership.

5. action owner

Turn 18. Action owner identifies the person responsible for carrying out a particular follow-up task.

6. handover checklist

Turn 20. Handover checklist records the tasks and confirmations needed to transfer responsibility without omissions.

Return to the conversation, page 103

Transfer exchange

1. transfer

Manager: The report arrived, so can we close the transfer task?

Turn 1. Transfer refers to moving workflow responsibility, which requires more than successful delivery.

Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

2. recipient

IT: First confirm the new owner and the authorized recipient list.

Turn 2. Recipient identifies who is permitted and expected to receive the report.

3. validation

Manager: I'll also compare the output with the agreed validation criteria.

Turn 3. Validation criteria state what the new owner must check before accepting the workflow.

4. complete

IT: Then record the result before marking the handover complete.

Turn 4. Complete means all agreed handover conditions have been satisfied and recorded.

Return to the conversation, page 105

Additional case 3 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. certificate

Turn 2. Certificate is the signed digital credential used in the portal's secure connection.

2. change window

Turn 8. Change window is the agreed period for planned service work, not a prediction of an outage.

3. validation plan

Turn 12. Validation plan specifies the checks needed to establish that the change works as intended.

4. on-call

Turn 16. On-call identifies the person or team assigned to respond during the relevant period.

5. change record

Turn 19. Change record documents the planned work, responsibilities, checks, and relevant evidence.

6. handoff

Turn 20. Handoff transfers the alert and response responsibility to a confirmed receiving owner.

Return to the conversation, page 107

Transfer exchange

1. warning

User: Should I click past the warning to reach the portal?

Turn 1. Warning is the browser's security notice, not a routine confirmation to dismiss.

Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

2. address

Support: No. Please report the exact portal address through our support channel.

Turn 2. Address identifies the endpoint involved and helps distinguish different portal routes.

3. message

User: I'll include the time and the wording of the message.

Turn 3. Message supplies the observed error text rather than a guessed diagnosis.

4. owner

Support: I'll escalate it to the named owner and keep you updated.

Turn 4. Owner is the person responsible for investigating and coordinating the issue.

Return to the conversation, page 109

Find a phrase by purpose

IT Service Language, Tickets, and Triage

Acknowledge impact: I understand the export is blocking your billing file.

Narrow the function: Which action fails after you sign in?

Check what works: Can you still view the invoices on screen?

Full phrase bank, page 7

Networks, Connectivity, and Root-Cause Hypotheses

Acknowledge a pattern: The reports do point to a difference between access paths.

Challenge certainty: What evidence establishes DNS rather than another path issue?

State a hypothesis: Name resolution is one explanation we still need to test.

Full phrase bank, page 17

Identity, Access, and Permissions

Clarify the action: Which report do you need, and what action must you perform?

Separate identity and access: You can sign in; the download permission is a different question.

Refuse proportionately: I cannot justify administrator rights from the stated reporting task.

Full phrase bank, page 30

Cloud, Infrastructure, and Cost-Aware Operations

Identify the mismatch: The estimates do not include the same services.

State the known difference: Option A excludes backup storage; Option B includes it.

Limit the arithmetic: The headline difference is $250, not a confirmed like-for-like saving.

Full phrase bank, page 40

Find a phrase by purpose / continued

Endpoints, Servers, Patching, and Configuration Management

Report the counts: Installation succeeded on 180 of 200 managed laptops.

Separate remaining states: Twelve were offline; eight returned installation errors.

Qualify completion: Verification is not yet complete on all reported successes.

Full phrase bank, page 52

Security Operations, Risk, and Incident Response

Lead with the event: An unusual-sign-in alert was recorded at 09:12 UTC.

State the unknown: The account owner has not yet confirmed the activity.

Escalate promptly: I am referring this through the approved response channel now.

Full phrase bank, page 62

Change, Release, Problem, and Post-Incident Communication

Own the error: The Tuesday date in my earlier notice was incorrect.

State the approved fact: The approved window is Thursday, 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time.

Replace the old record: This correction supersedes the earlier maintenance notice.

Full phrase bank, page 76

Platform, DevOps, Observability, and Kubernetes Conversations

Validate both observations: The CPU panel is normal, and users are reporting slow checkout.

Challenge the inference: That metric alone does not establish service health.

Ask about the journey: Which part of checkout is slow from the user's perspective?

Full phrase bank, page 87

Vocabulary index

acceptance criteria
Case 1, p. 98

access denied
Lesson 03, p. 29

access policy
Lesson 02, p. 16

access request
Lesson 03, p. 29

access review
Lesson 03, p. 29

acknowledgment
Lesson 07, p. 75

action owner
Lesson 07, p. 75, Case 2, p. 102

administrator
Lesson 03, p. 28

affected user
Lesson 01, p. 5

alert
Lesson 06, p. 60

anomaly
Lesson 06, p. 60

approver
Lesson 03, p. 29

asset inventory
Lesson 05, p. 50

assignment group
Lesson 01, p. 6

audit log
Lesson 03, p. 29

authentication
Lesson 03, p. 28

authorization
Lesson 03, p. 28

availability zone
Lesson 04, p. 38

backup
Lesson 04, p. 38

block storage
Lesson 04, p. 38

breach
Lesson 06, p. 60

business justification
Lesson 03, p. 29

cache
Lesson 02, p. 15

certificate
Lesson 02, p. 16, Case 3, p. 106

chain of custody
Lesson 06, p. 61

change approval
Lesson 07, p. 74

change freeze
Lesson 07, p. 75

change owner
Lesson 07, p. 74

change record
Lesson 07, p. 74, Case 3, p. 106

change window
Case 3, p. 106

closure criterion
Lesson 01, p. 6

cloud service
Lesson 04, p. 38

cluster
Lesson 08, p. 85

completion criterion
Lesson 05, p. 51

compliance state
Lesson 05, p. 51

compromise
Lesson 06, p. 60

configuration baseline
Lesson 05, p. 51

configuration drift
Lesson 05, p. 51

connection refusal
Lesson 02, p. 16

consumption
Lesson 04, p. 39

container
Lesson 08, p. 85

containment
Lesson 06, p. 61

correction
Lesson 07, p. 75

cost allocation
Lesson 04, p. 39

Vocabulary index / continued

CPU
Lesson 08, p. 86

cutoff
Case 2, p. 102

database wait
Lesson 08, p. 86

dependencies
Case 1, p. 98

dependency
Lesson 05, p. 51, Lesson 07, p. 75

deployment
Lesson 05, p. 50, Lesson 07, p. 74, Lesson 08, p. 85

deployment ring
Lesson 05, p. 51

deprovisioning
Lesson 03, p. 28

DevOps
Lesson 08, p. 85

diagnostic hypothesis
Lesson 02, p. 16

DNS
Lesson 02, p. 15

due date
Lesson 07, p. 75

duplicate ticket
Lesson 01, p. 6

egress
Lesson 04, p. 39

elapsed time
Case 1, p. 98

emergency change
Lesson 07, p. 75

endpoint
Lesson 05, p. 50

entitlement
Lesson 03, p. 28

eradication
Lesson 06, p. 61

error code
Lesson 05, p. 51

error message
Lesson 01, p. 5

escalation
Lesson 01, p. 6

escalation threshold
Lesson 06, p. 61

event
Lesson 06, p. 60

evidence preservation
Lesson 06, p. 61

exception
Lesson 05, p. 51

exclusion
Lesson 04, p. 39

expiration
Lesson 03, p. 29

false positive
Lesson 06, p. 60

firewall
Lesson 02, p. 16

gateway
Lesson 02, p. 15

geolocation
Lesson 06, p. 60

handoff
Case 3, p. 106

handover checklist
Case 2, p. 102

hostname
Lesson 02, p. 15

identity
Lesson 03, p. 28

impact
Lesson 01, p. 5

implementation plan
Lesson 07, p. 74

incident
Lesson 01, p. 5

indicator
Lesson 06, p. 60

infrastructure
Lesson 04, p. 38

ingress
Lesson 04, p. 39, Lesson 08, p. 85

installation
Lesson 05, p. 50

instance
Lesson 04, p. 38

Vocabulary index / continued

IP address
Lesson 02, p. 15

known error
Lesson 07, p. 75

least privilege
Lesson 03, p. 28

liveness
Lesson 08, p. 85

maintenance notice
Lesson 07, p. 74

managed device
Lesson 05, p. 50

MFA
Lesson 03, p. 29

need to know
Lesson 06, p. 61

notification
Lesson 06, p. 61

observability
Lesson 08, p. 86

on-call
Lesson 06, p. 60, Case 3, p. 106

packet loss
Lesson 02, p. 16

patch level
Lesson 05, p. 50

pilot group
Lesson 05, p. 51

pod
Lesson 08, p. 85

post-implementation review
Lesson 07, p. 75

priority
Lesson 01, p. 5

problem record
Lesson 07, p. 75

proxy
Lesson 02, p. 16

reachability
Lesson 02, p. 16

reboot
Lesson 05, p. 50

recovery
Lesson 06, p. 61

knowledge article
Lesson 01, p. 6

Kubernetes
Lesson 08, p. 85

line item
Lesson 04, p. 39

log
Lesson 08, p. 86

maintenance window
Lesson 05, p. 50, Lesson 07, p. 74

metric
Lesson 08, p. 86

name resolution
Lesson 02, p. 15

node
Lesson 08, p. 85

object storage
Lesson 04, p. 38

offline
Lesson 05, p. 50

on-demand
Lesson 04, p. 39

patch
Lesson 05, p. 50

permission
Lesson 03, p. 28

platform
Lesson 08, p. 85

port
Lesson 02, p. 16

post-incident review
Lesson 06, p. 61

privileged access
Lesson 03, p. 28

provisioning
Lesson 03, p. 28

RBAC
Lesson 03, p. 28

readiness
Lesson 08, p. 85

recipient list
Lesson 07, p. 74

recovery point
Case 1, p. 98

Vocabulary index / continued

region
Lesson 04, p. 38

release
Lesson 07, p. 74

remediation
Lesson 05, p. 51

replica
Lesson 08, p. 86

reproduce
Lesson 01, p. 6

reservation
Lesson 04, p. 39

resolution
Lesson 01, p. 6

resolver
Lesson 02, p. 15

resource limit
Lesson 08, p. 86

resource request
Lesson 08, p. 86

response time
Lesson 01, p. 6

restoration time
Lesson 01, p. 6

restore duration
Case 1, p. 98

restore test
Lesson 04, p. 38

retention period
Lesson 04, p. 38

retention policy
Case 2, p. 102

retry
Lesson 05, p. 50

right-sizing
Lesson 04, p. 39

role
Lesson 03, p. 28

rollback
Lesson 05, p. 51

rollback plan
Lesson 07, p. 74

round-trip time
Lesson 02, p. 16

route
Lesson 02, p. 15

routing
Lesson 02, p. 15

RPO
Lesson 04, p. 39

RTO
Lesson 04, p. 39

saturation
Lesson 08, p. 86

scope
Lesson 01, p. 5

scope assessment
Lesson 06, p. 61

separation of duties
Lesson 03, p. 29

service
Lesson 08, p. 85

service account
Lesson 03, p. 29, Case 2, p. 102

service desk
Lesson 01, p. 5

service owner
Lesson 01, p. 6

service request
Lesson 01, p. 5

session
Lesson 06, p. 60

severity
Lesson 06, p. 61

sign-in log
Lesson 06, p. 60

snapshot
Lesson 04, p. 38

SOC
Lesson 06, p. 60

source of truth
Lesson 07, p. 75

span
Lesson 08, p. 86

SSO
Lesson 03, p. 29

stakeholder
Lesson 07, p. 74

Vocabulary index / continued

status update
Lesson 01, p. 6

supersede
Lesson 07, p. 75

symptom
Lesson 01, p. 5

test record
Case 1, p. 98

timeline
Lesson 06, p. 61

TLS
Lesson 02, p. 16

trace
Lesson 08, p. 86

TTL
Lesson 02, p. 15

user journey
Lesson 08, p. 86

validation plan
Case 3, p. 106

virtual machine
Lesson 04, p. 38

workaround
Lesson 01, p. 6

subnet
Lesson 02, p. 15

supersedence
Lesson 05, p. 51

temporary access
Lesson 03, p. 29

ticket
Lesson 01, p. 5

timeout
Lesson 02, p. 16

total cost
Lesson 04, p. 39

triage
Lesson 01, p. 5

urgency
Lesson 01, p. 5

validation
Lesson 07, p. 74, Case 2, p. 102

verification
Lesson 05, p. 50

VPN
Lesson 02, p. 15

References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.

[1] NIST. SP 800-61 Revision 3: Incident Response Recommendations and Considerations for Cybersecurity Risk Management (2025).

Background for incident coordination and accountable risk decisions. The fictional cases do not reproduce an operational response procedure. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://csrc.nist.gov/pubs/sp/800/61/r3/final

[2] Google SRE book. Monitoring Distributed Systems.

Background for symptoms versus causes, user-visible monitoring and constrained-capacity signals. No example incident or operating instruction is reproduced. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://sre.google/sre-book/monitoring-distributed-systems/

[3] Kubernetes documentation. Liveness, Readiness, and Startup Probes.

Primary terminology for distinct probe purposes. A configured readiness check is not a universal test of user-visible transactions. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://kubernetes.io/docs/concepts/workloads/pods/probes/

[4] NIST SP 800-34 Rev. 1. Contingency Planning Guide for Federal Information Systems.

Background for recovery planning and testing terminology. The fictional service objectives are case facts, not requirements imposed by NIST on every organization. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://csrc.nist.gov/pubs/sp/800/34/r1/upd1/final

> **Companion course**
>
> The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.
>
> https://englishladder.com/efsp-general-it.html

Clear language for reliable services and accountable decisions.

Clarify the fault, test the explanation, and communicate the next action precisely.

IT Service Language, Tickets, and Triage

Urgency concerns time pressure; impact concerns consequences and scope. Priority normally reflects an organization's agreed assessment, not just the strongest wording in a ticket. A response commitment is not a repair guarantee.

Networks, Connectivity, and Root-Cause Hypotheses

A timeout, a refused connection, and a certificate warning are different observations. "The VPN is connected" does not establish that every destination is reachable. Name the source, destination, and observed result.

Identity, Access, and Permissions

Authentication establishes identity evidence; authorization governs permitted actions. Being able to sign in does not imply permission to download every report. A role name alone does not prove its actual rights.

Cloud, Infrastructure, and Cost-Aware Operations

The $250 difference compares two headline estimates with different inclusions. It is not a verified saving for equivalent services. RPO describes a data-loss interval; RTO describes a restoration-time target.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.

English Ladder / English for Work / Revised 2026 edition

This publication includes AI-generated text and cover illustration, revised and checked during production. Brand artwork remains the English Ladder mark. This edition makes no claim of independent professional certification.

Typeface: Bitstream Vera, embedded under its accompanying license. Illustration created with OpenAI's native image generator for this edition. The copyright notice is not a claim to ownership of third-party frameworks or references.